

# Collapsing Towers of Interpreters



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# The Challenge

Collapse

a tower of interpreters

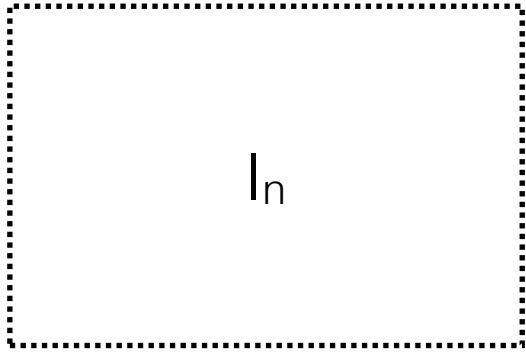
(languages  $L_0, \dots, L_n$  & interpreters for  $L_{i+1}$  written in  $L_i$ )

into

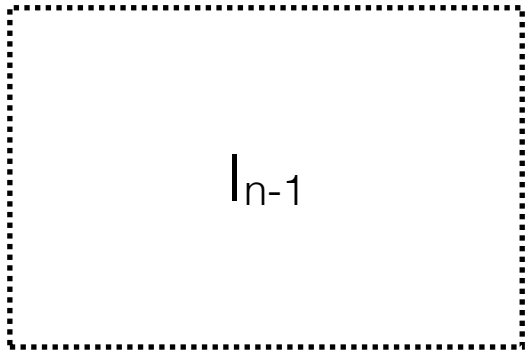
a one-pass compiler from  $L_n$  to  $L_0$

removing all interpretive overhead

$L_n$

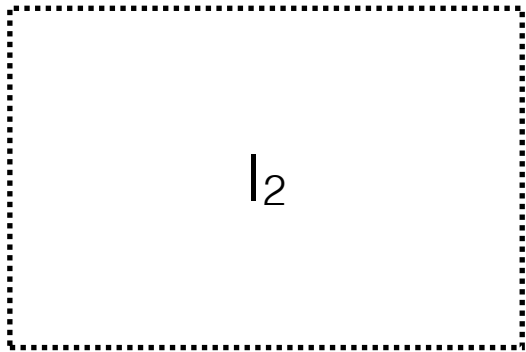


$I_{n-1}$

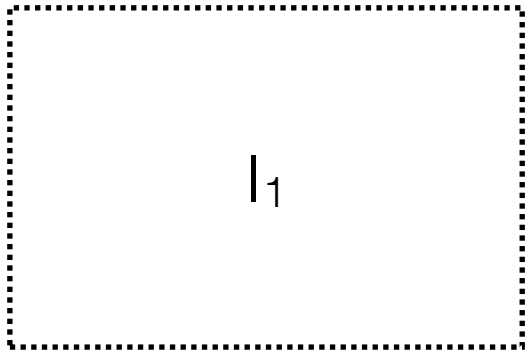


$\dots$

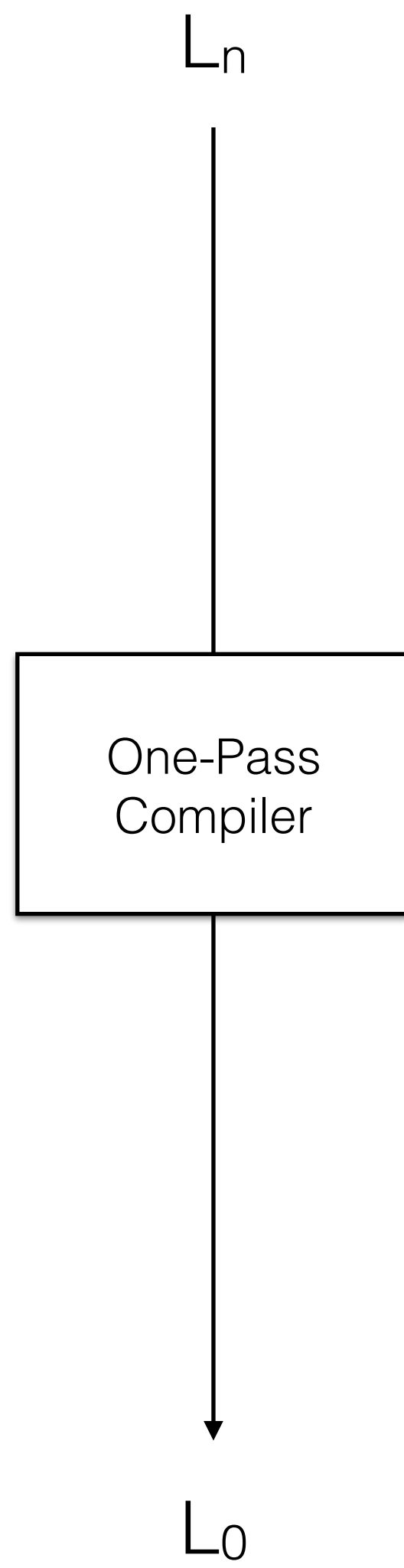
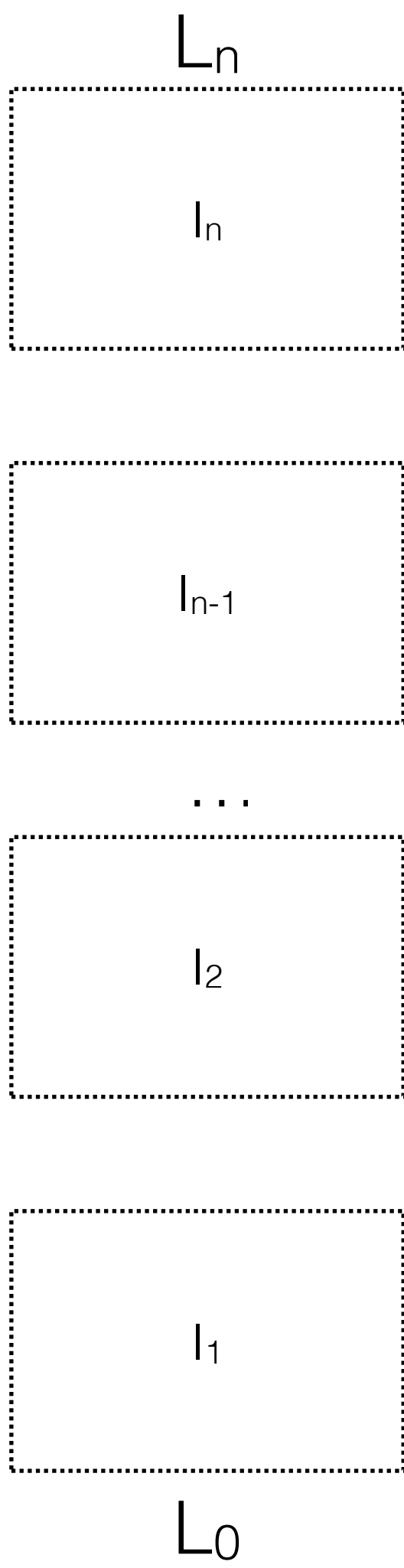
$I_2$



$I_1$



$L_0$



$L_n$

Python

$I_n$

$I_n$

bytecode

$I_{n-1}$

$I_{n-1}$

...

x86 runtime

$I_2$

$I_2$

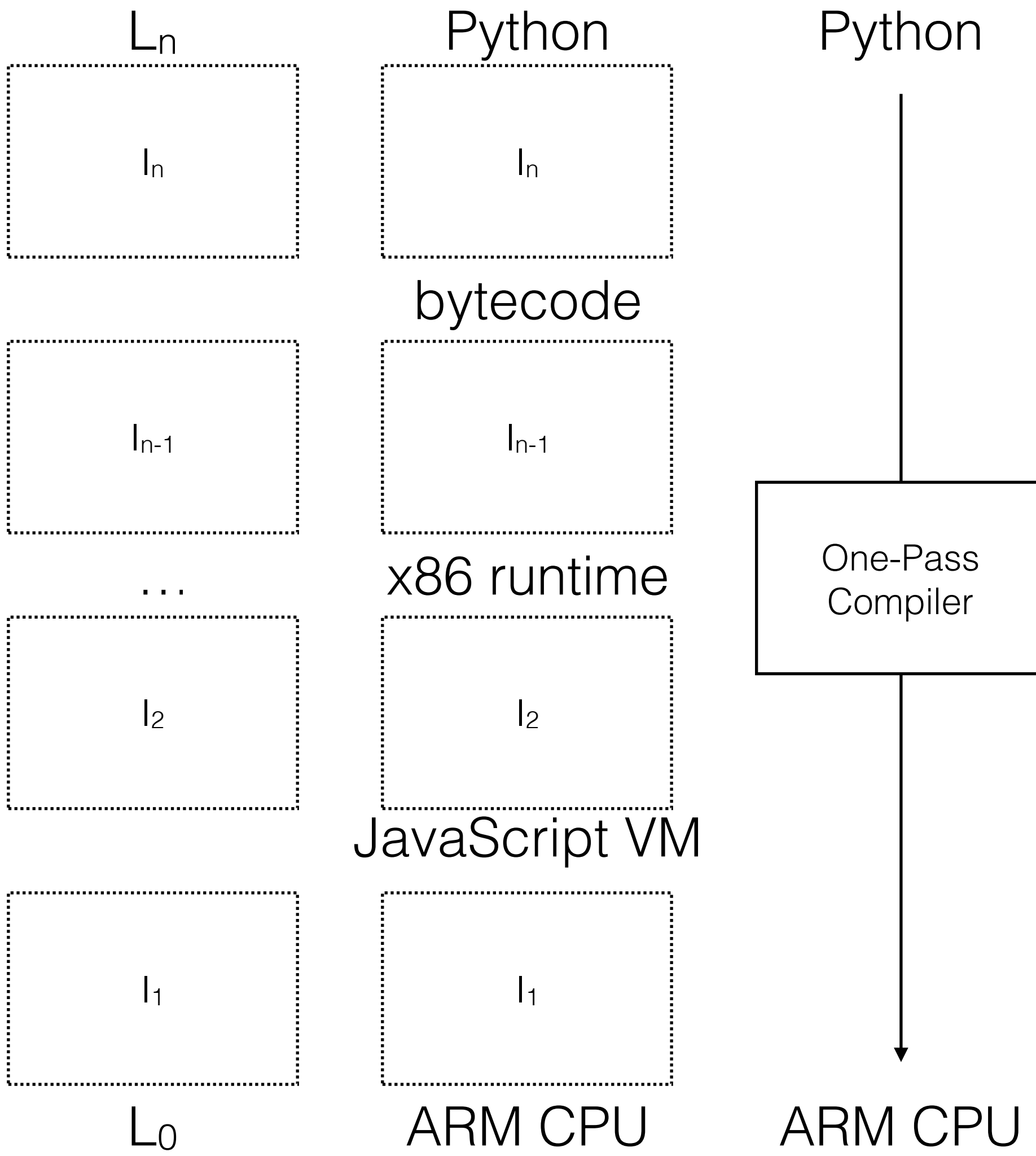
JavaScript VM

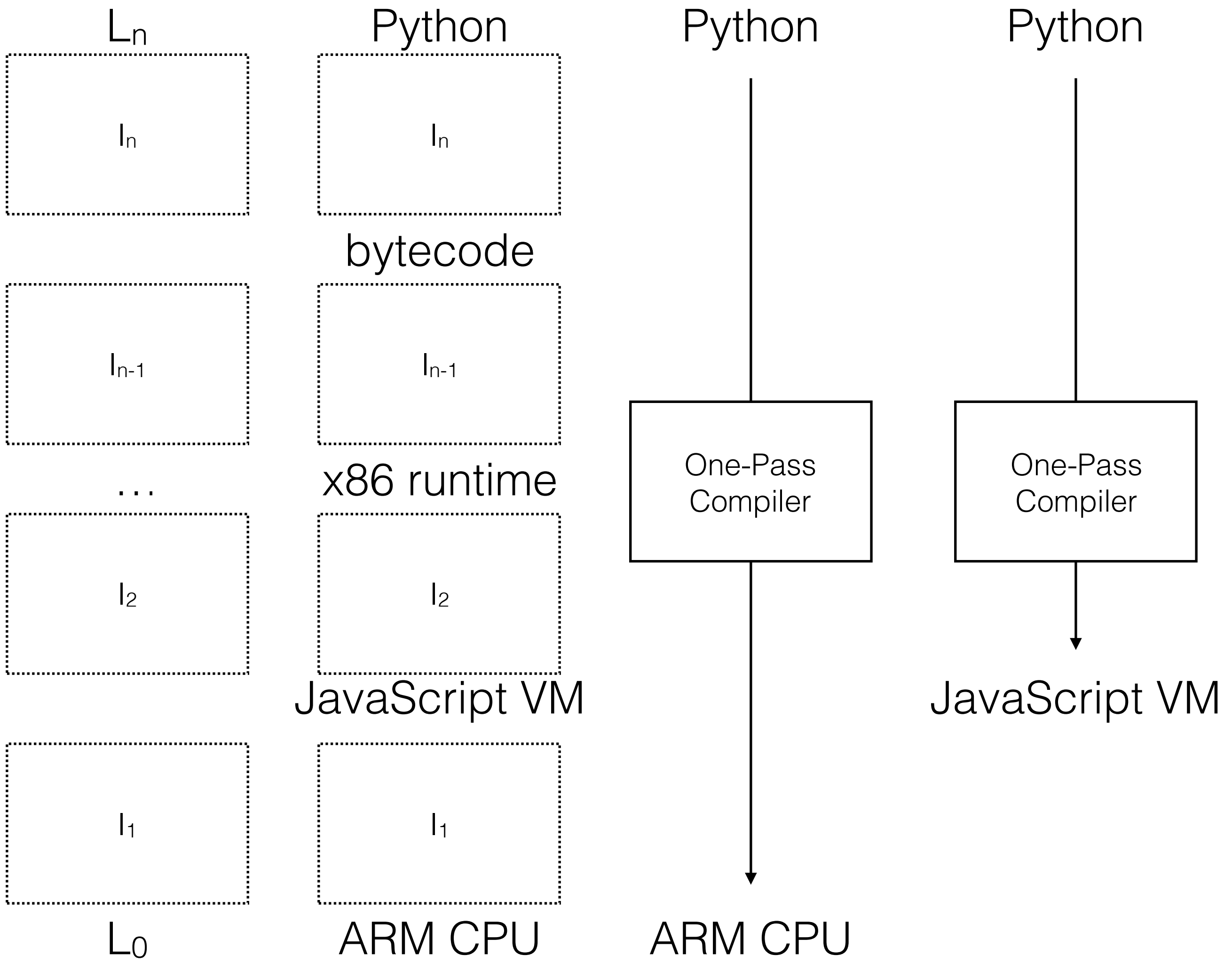
$I_1$

$I_1$

$L_0$

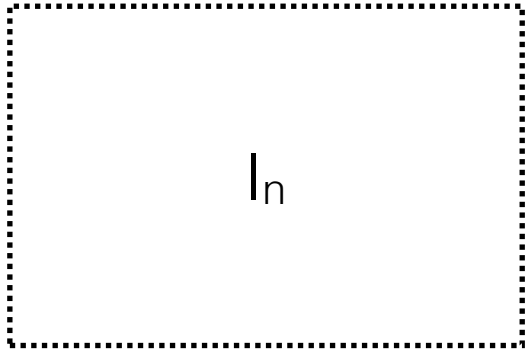
ARM CPU



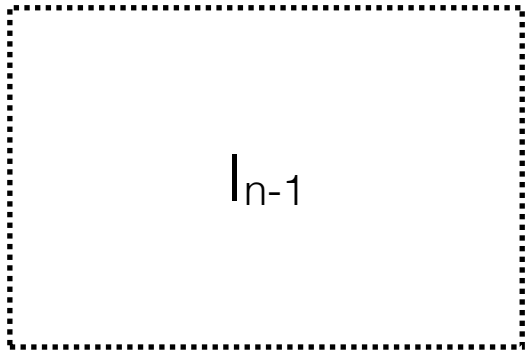




$L_n$

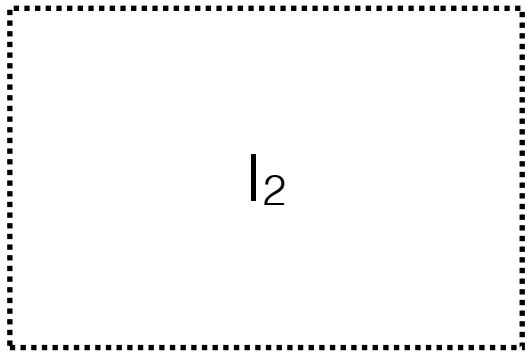


$I_{n-1}$

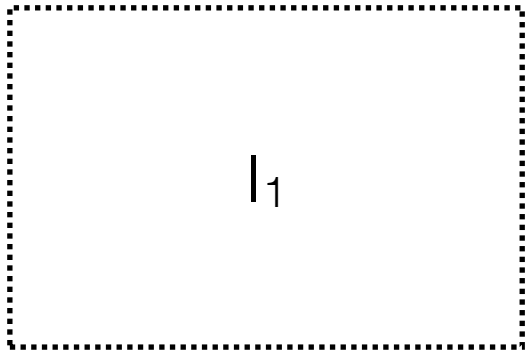


$\dots$

$I_2$



$I_1$



$L_0$



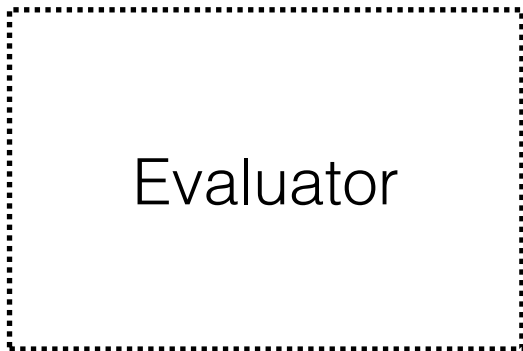
Regex



High Level



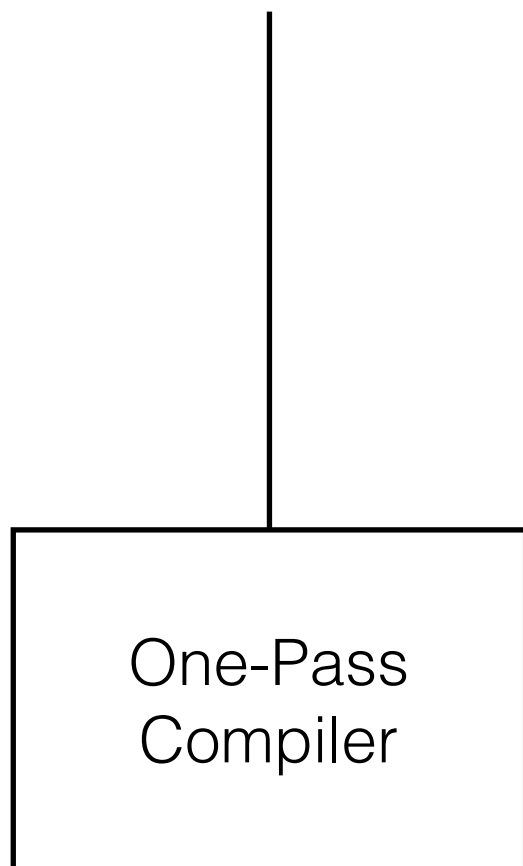
...



Low Level



Regex

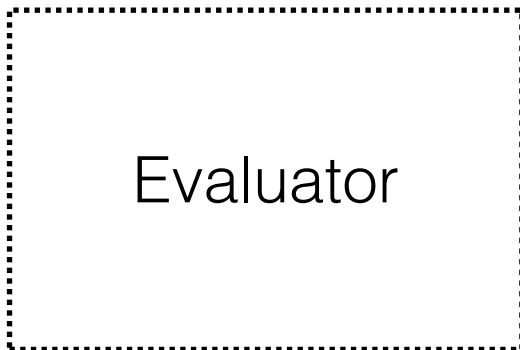


Low Level

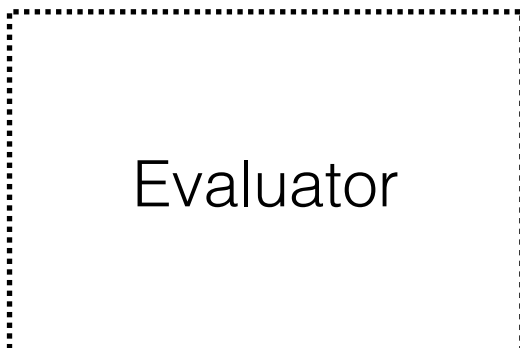
High Level



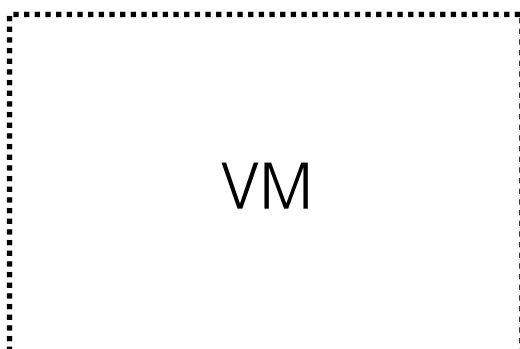
High Level



...



Low Level

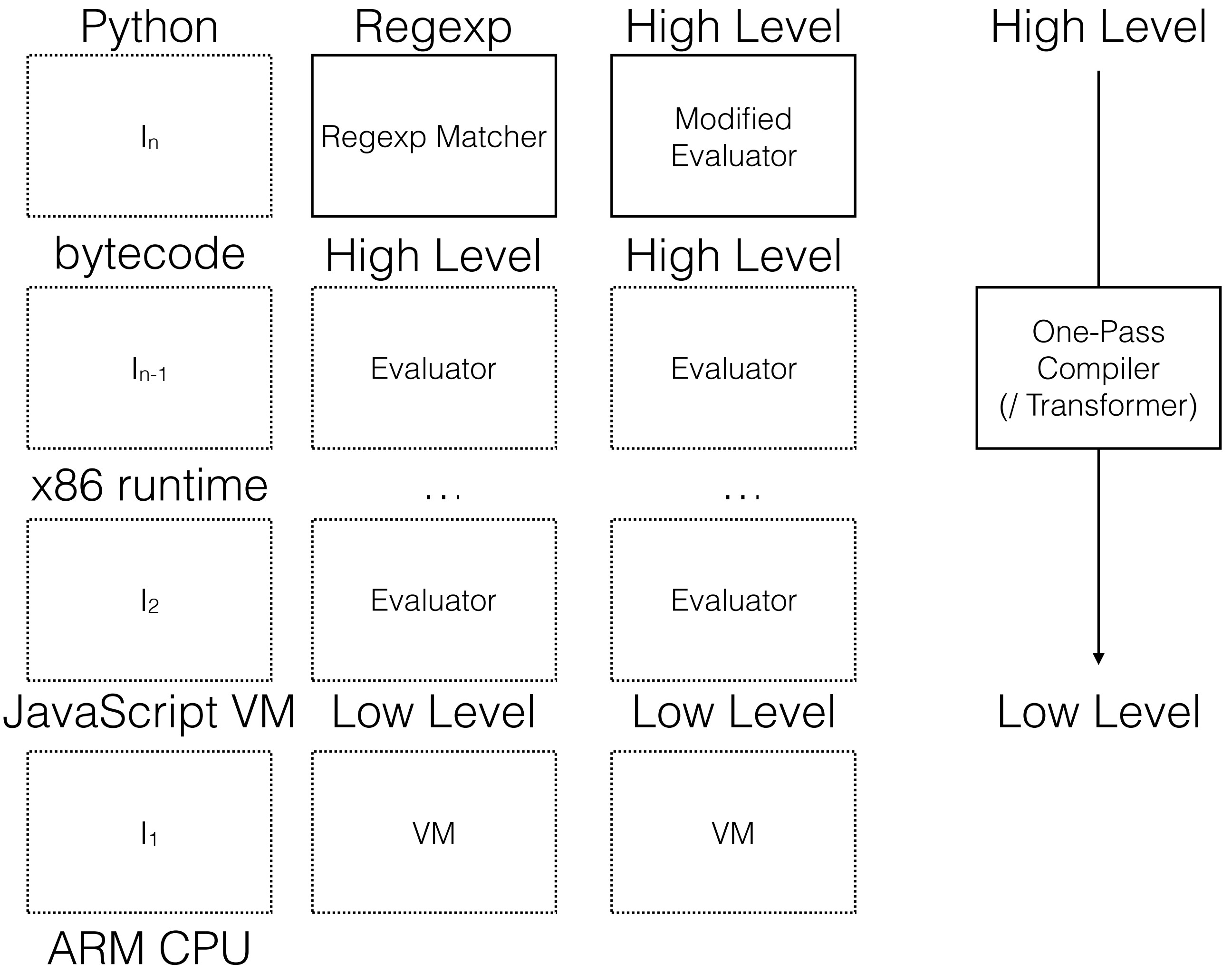


High Level

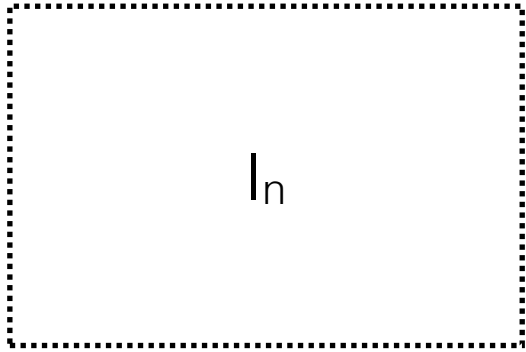


Low Level

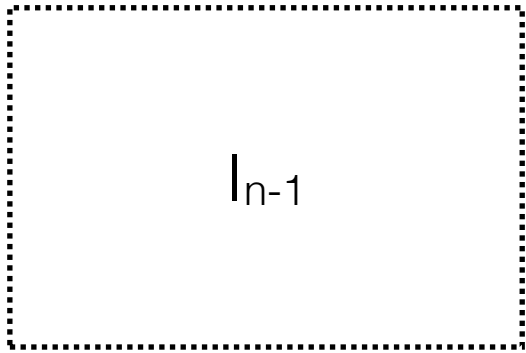




$L_n$

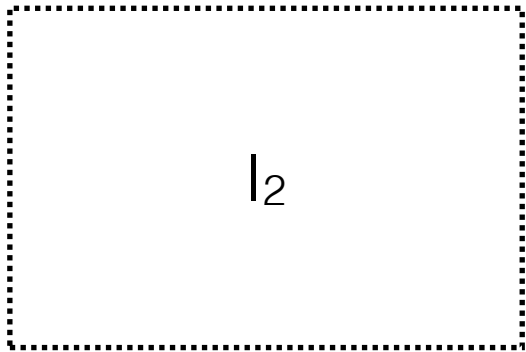


$I_n$

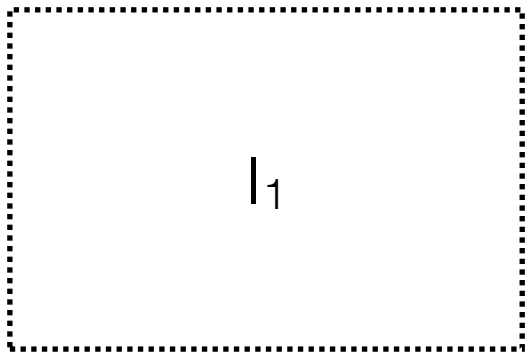


$I_{n-1}$

$\dots$

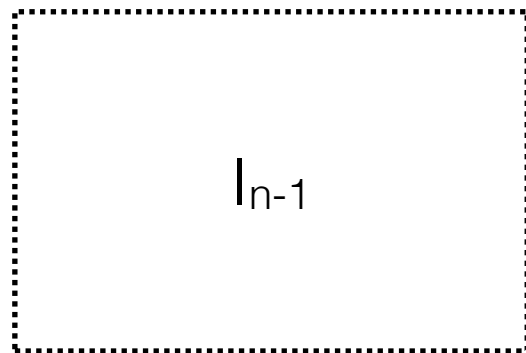
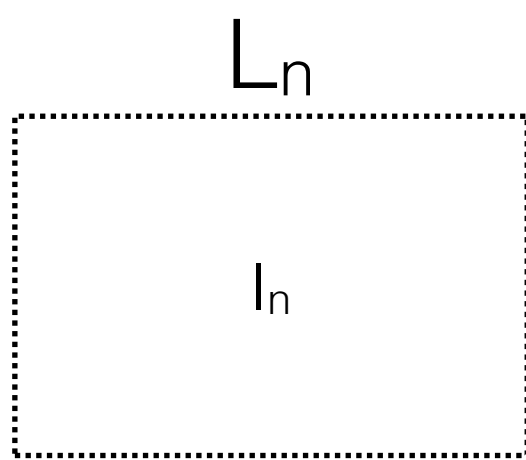


$I_2$

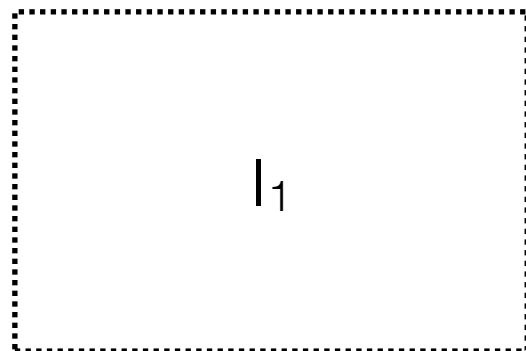
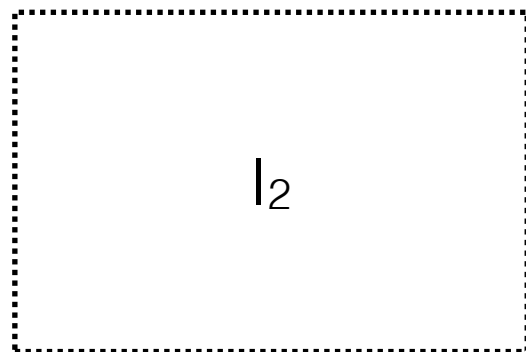


$I_1$

$L_0$



...



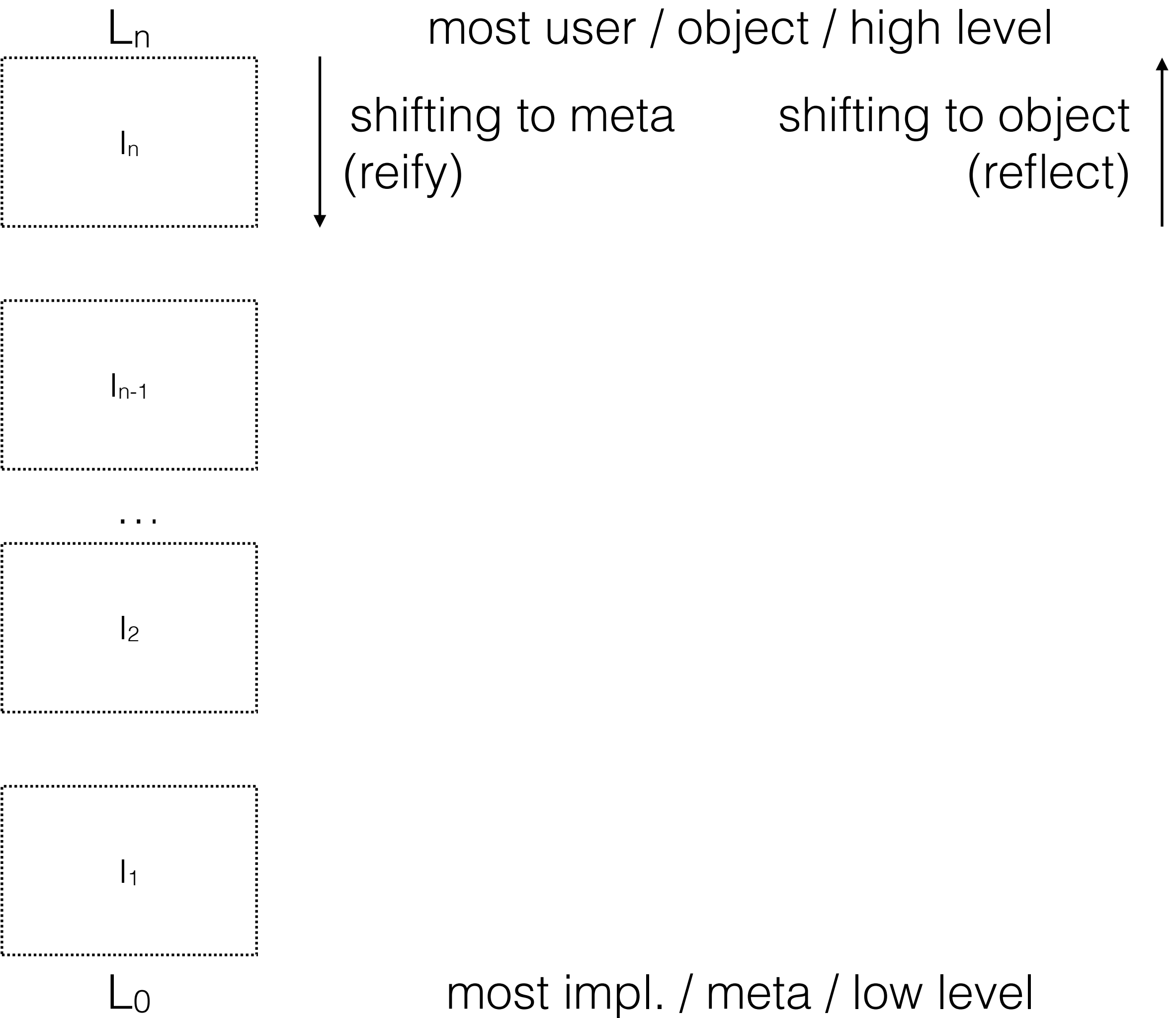
$L_0$

~ conceptually **infinite**

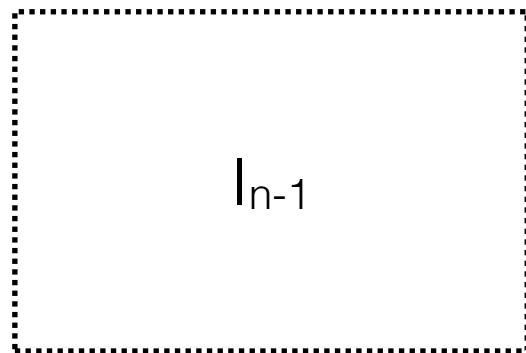
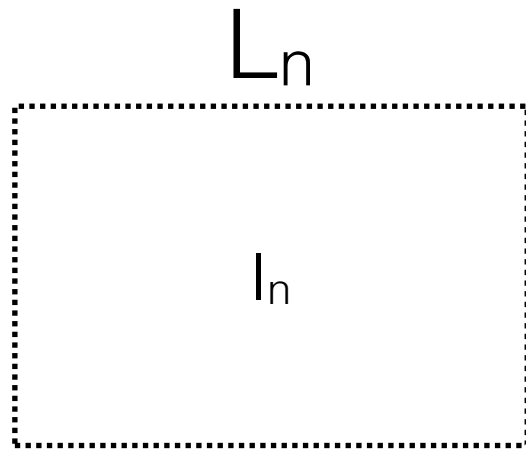
~ **reflective**

can be inspected and modified  
at runtime

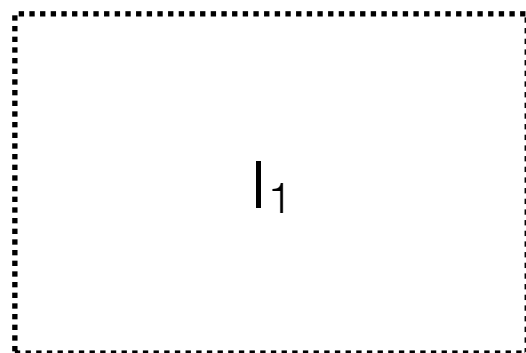
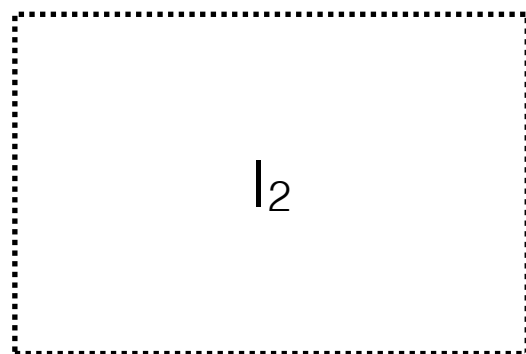
base  $L_0$  = variant of  **$\lambda$ -calculus**



most impl. / meta / low level



...



$L_0$



shifting to meta  
(reify)



shifting to object  
(reflect)

most user / object / high level



$L_\infty$

...

$L_n$

conceptually infinite

default semantics

finite execution

$I_n$

$I_{n-1}$

...

$I_2$

$I_1$

$L_0$

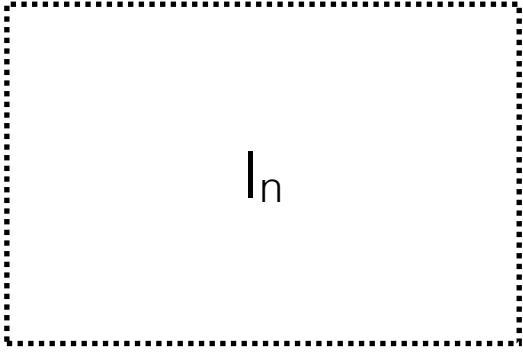
shifting to meta  
(reify)

shifting to object  
(reflect)

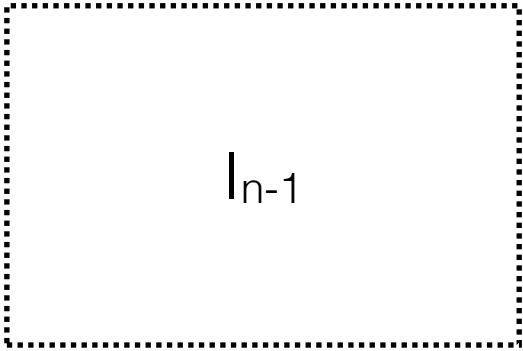
most user / object / high level



$L_n$

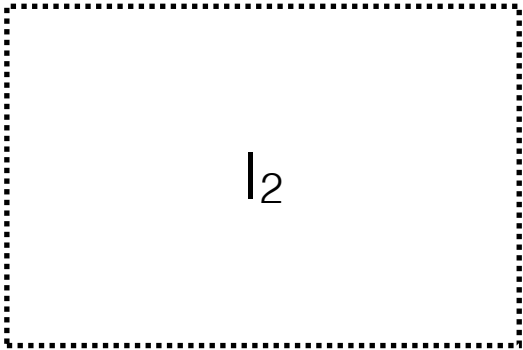


$I_{n-1}$

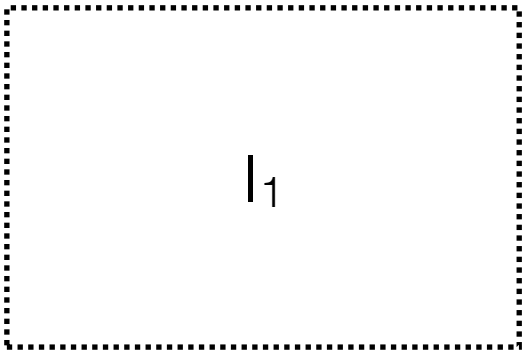


$\dots$

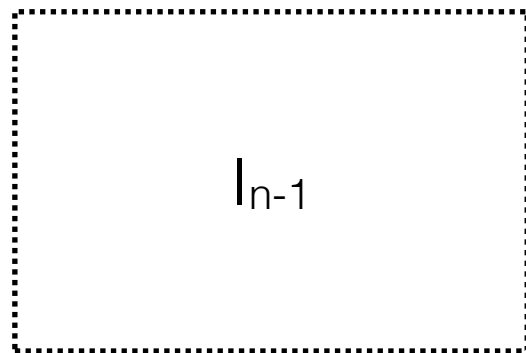
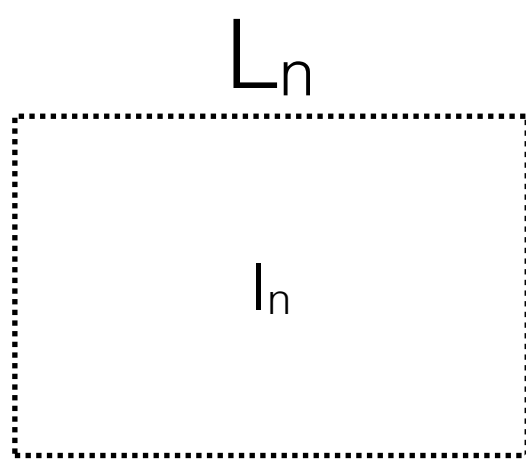
$I_2$



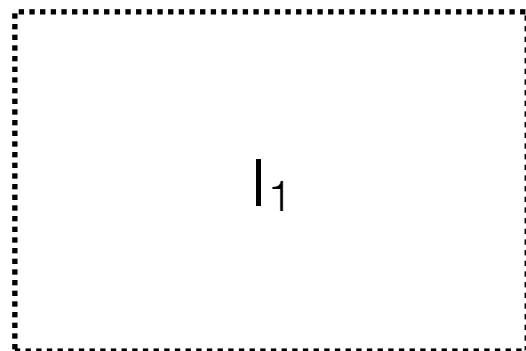
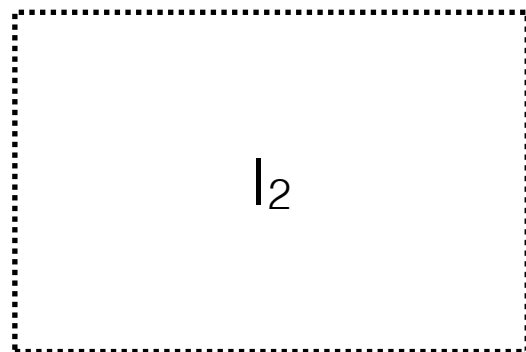
$I_1$



$L_0$



...



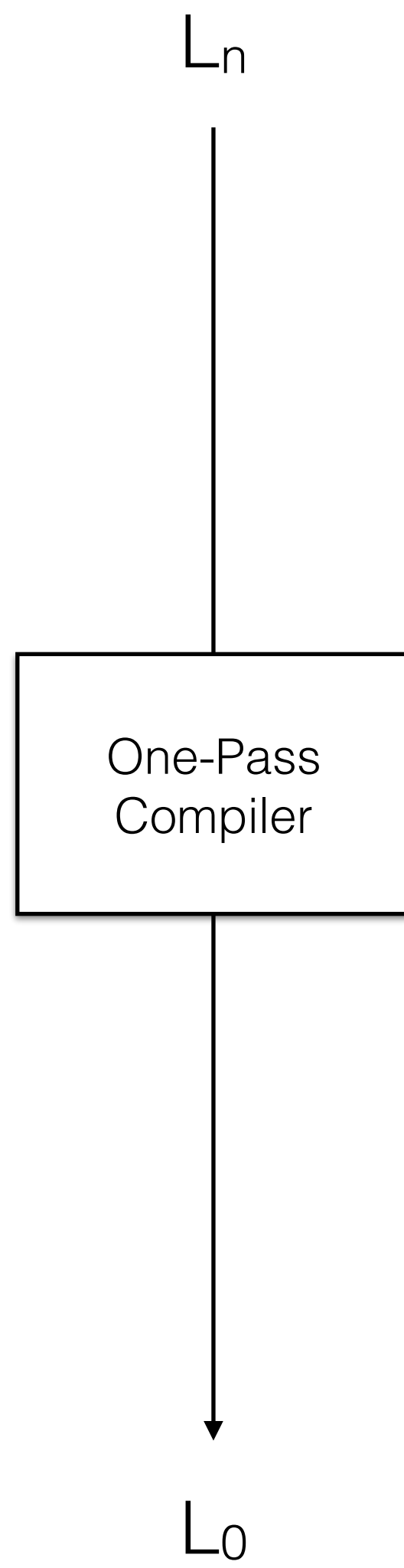
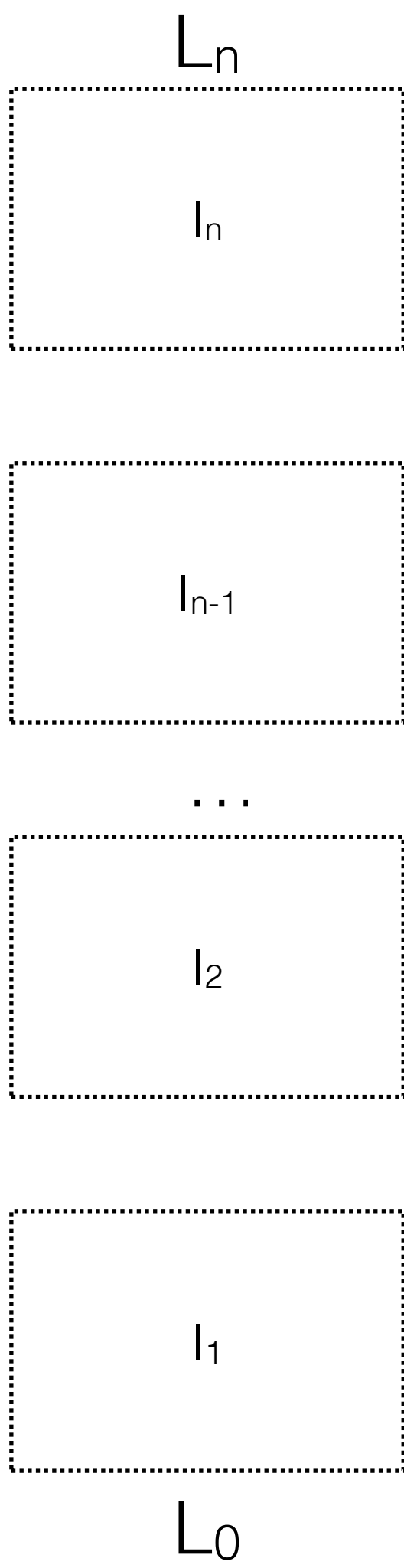
$L_0$

~ conceptually **infinite**

~ **reflective**

can be inspected and modified  
at runtime

base  $L_0$  = variant of  **$\lambda$ -calculus**



# Example in Purple/Black

```
(define fib (lambda (n)
  (if (< n 2) n
      (+ (fib (- n 1)) (fib (- n 2))))))
```

```
> (fib 7) ;; => 13
```



# Reflection in Purple/Black

```
(EM (begin ;; EM = Execute-at-Metalevel
(define counter 0)
(define old-eval-var eval-var)
(set! eval-var (lambda (e r k)
  (if (eq? e 'n)
    (set! counter (+ counter 1))
    (old-eval-var e r k)))))
```

```
> (fib 7) ;; => 13
> (EM counter) ;; => 102
```



# Compilation in Purple

```
(set! fib (clambda (n) ;; c = compiled  
  (if (< n 2) n  
    (+ (fib (- n 1)) (fib (- n 2))))))
```

```
> (EM (set! counter 0))  
> (fib 7) ;; => 13  
> (EM counter) ;; => 102
```



# Compilation in Purple

```
(EM (set! eval-var old-eval-var))
```

```
> (EM (set! counter 0))
```

```
> (fib 7) ;; => 13
```

```
> (EM counter) ;; => 102
```

```
(set! fib (lambda (n) ...))
```

```
> (EM (set! counter 0))
```

```
> (fib 7) ;; => 13
```

```
> (EM counter) ;; => 0
```





# Collapse in Purple

```
{(k, xs) => _app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)'),  
_cont{c_1 => _cell_set(<cell counter>, c_1) _app('<', _cons(_car(xs),  
'(2)'), _cont{v_1 => _if(_true(v_1),  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)'), _cont{c_2 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_2)  
_app(k, _cons(_car(xs), '()), _cont{v_2 => v_2}})}),  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)'), _cont{c_3 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_3)  
_app('-', _cons(_car(xs), '(1)'), _cont{v_3 => _app(_cell_read(<cell  
fib>), _cons(v_3, '()), _cont{v_4 =>  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)'), _cont{c_4 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_4)  
_app('-', _cons(_car(xs), '(2)'), _cont{v_5 => _app(_cell_read(<cell  
fib>), _cons(v_5, '()), _cont{v_6 =>  
_app('+', _cons(v_4, _cons(v_6, '()))}, _cont{v_7 => _app(k,  
_cons(v_7, '()), _cont{v_8 => v_8}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}
```





# Solving the Challenge



# 1971

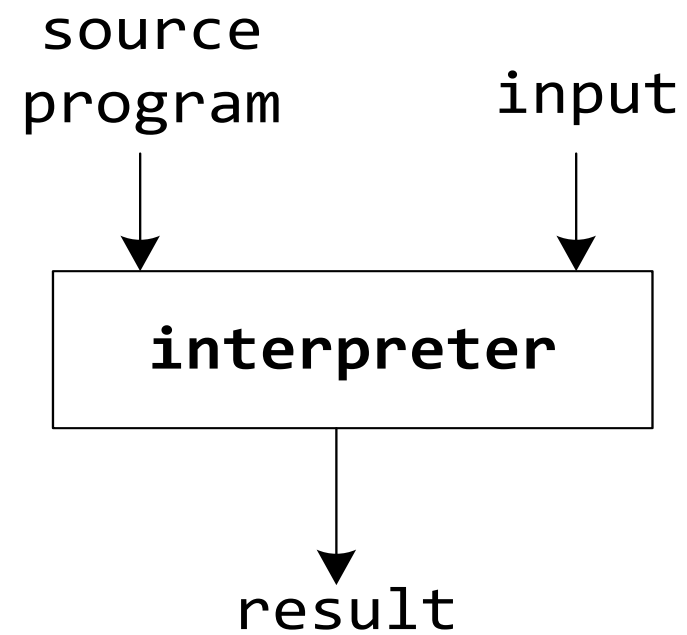
Partial Evaluation of Computation Process  
and its Application to Compiler Generation



**Yoshihiko Futamura**

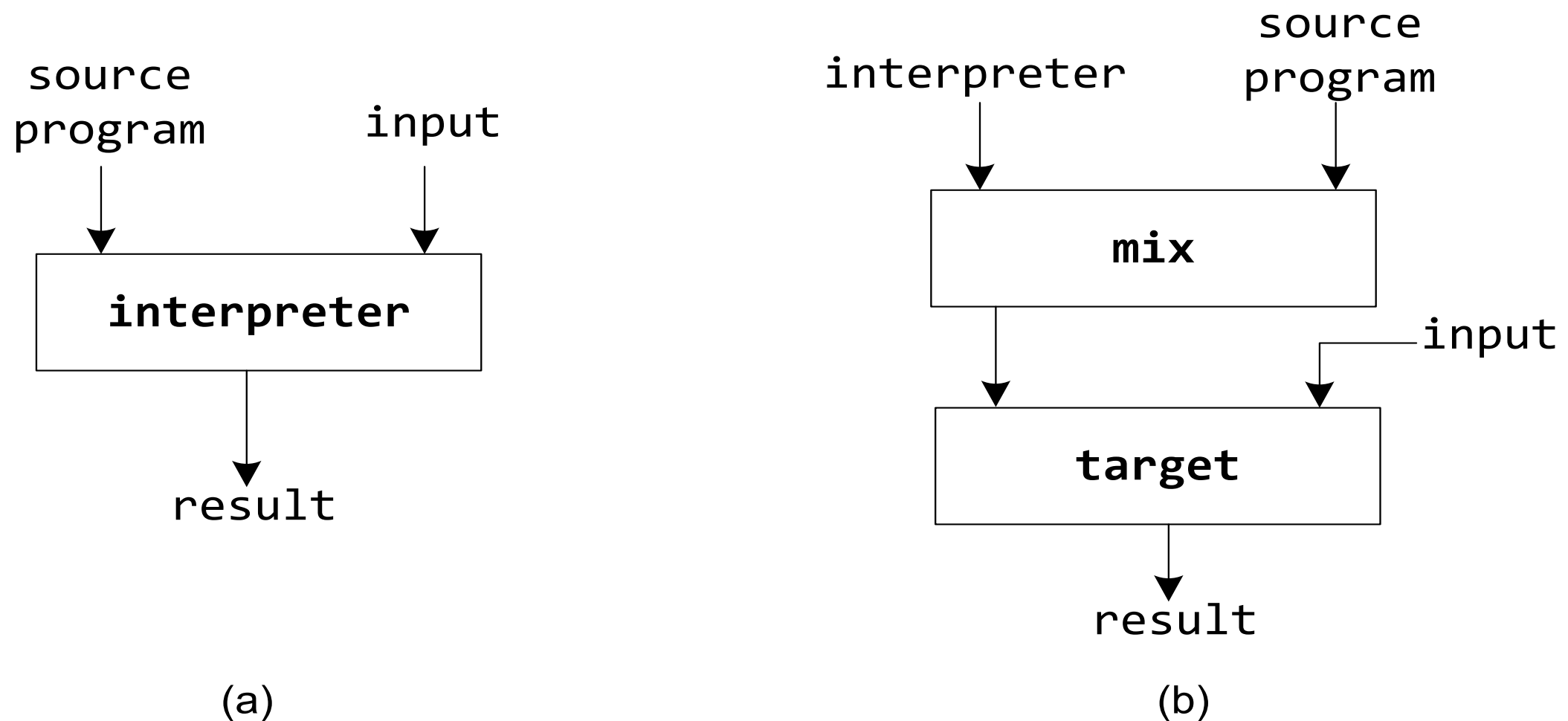
Yoshihiko Futamura,  
Central Research Laboratory, Hitachi, Ltd.  
Kokubunji, Tokyo, Japan.

# The 1<sup>st</sup> Futamura Projection



(a)

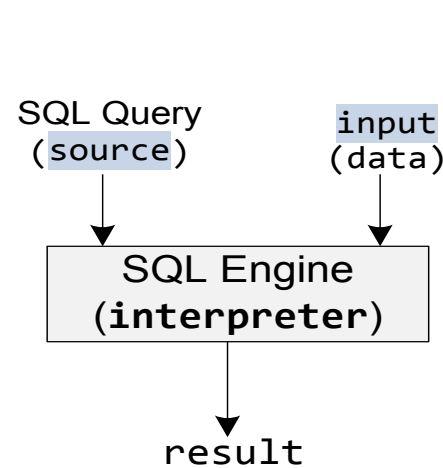
# The 1<sup>st</sup> Futamura Projection



Specializing an **interpreter** with respect to a program produces a **compiled** version of that program.

# Practical Realization

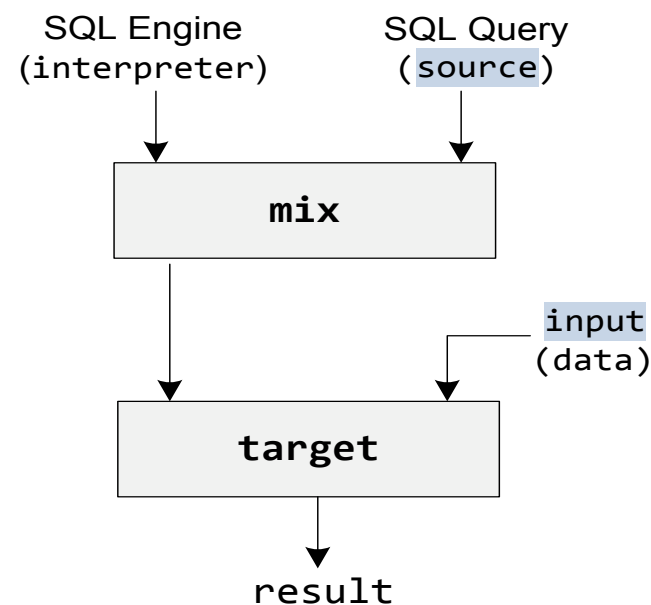
```
result = interpreter(source, input)
```



(a)

Query Interpreter

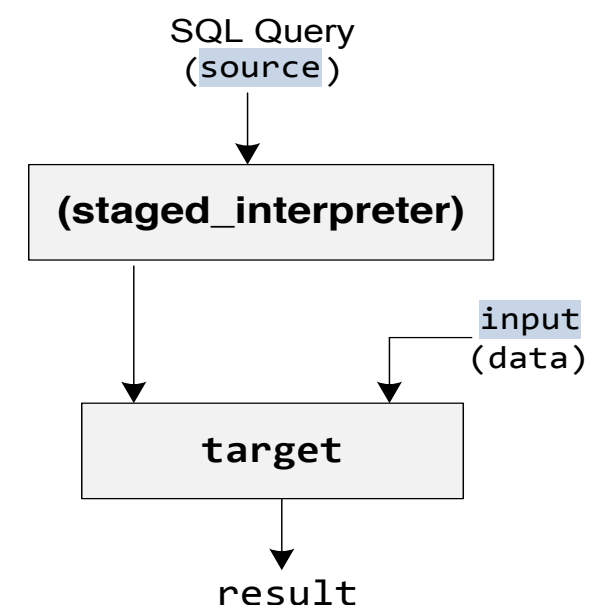
```
target = mix(interpreter, source)
result = target(input)
```



(b)

The first Futamura Projection

```
target = staged_interpreter(source)
result = target(input)
```



(c)

The first Futamura Projection  
realization through specialization

Automatic partial evaluation is a hard problem due to  
binding-time analysis (BTA).

Solution: start with a binding-time annotated (staged) program,  
in a multi-level language.

image credit: Ruby Tahboub (Purdue)

A staged interpreter yields a compiler.



# Staging

- multi-level language

$n \mid x \mid e @^b e \mid \lambda^b x . e \mid \dots$

- MetaML

$n \mid x \mid e \ e \mid \lambda x . e \mid \langle e \rangle \mid \sim e \mid \text{run } e$

- Lightweight Modular Staging (LMS) in Scala  
driven by types:  $T$  vs  $\text{Rep}[T]$

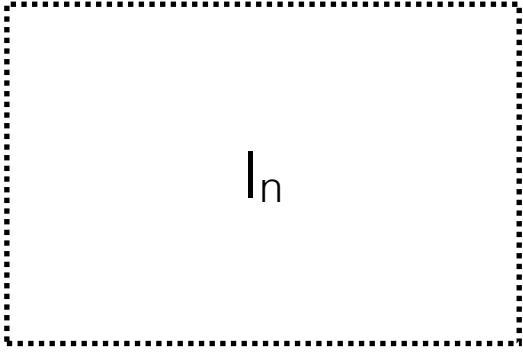


A staged interpreter yields a compiler.

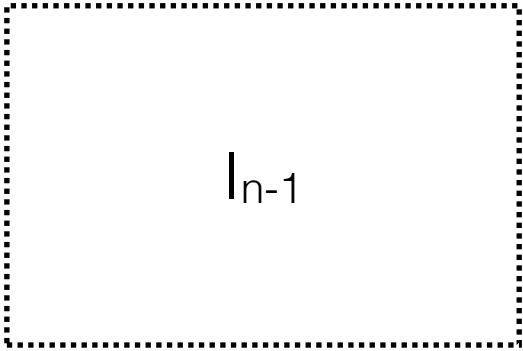




$L_n$

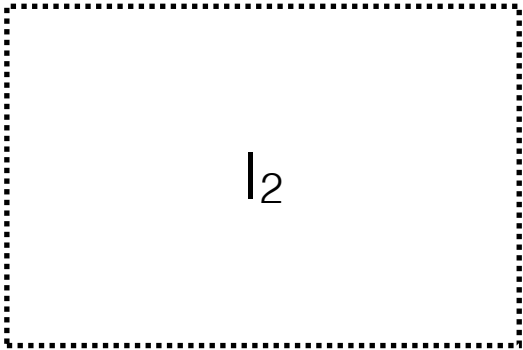


$I_n$

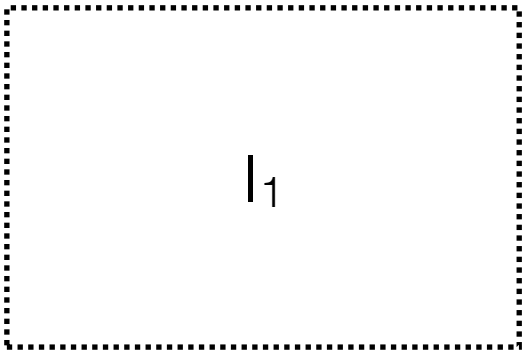


$I_{n-1}$

$\dots$



$I_2$



$I_1$

$L_0$

$L_n$

**staged**  $l_n$

**staged**  $l_{n-1}$

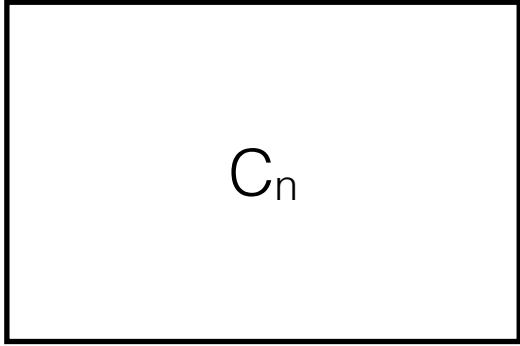
...

**staged**  $l_2$

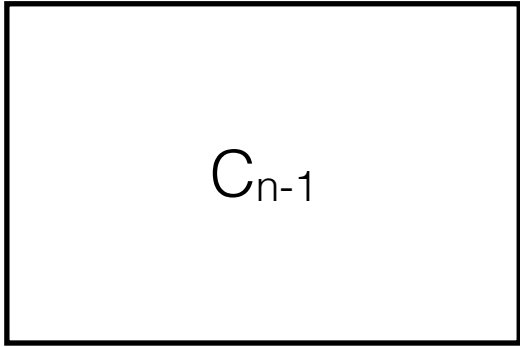
**staged**  $l_1$

$L_0$

$L_n$

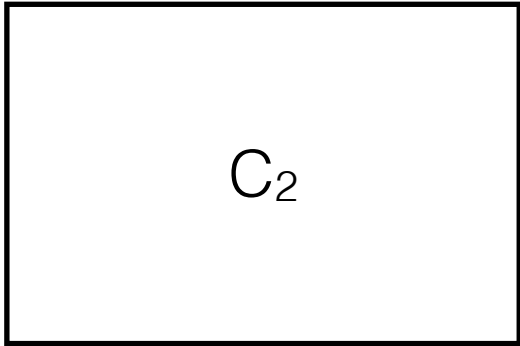


$C_{n-1}$

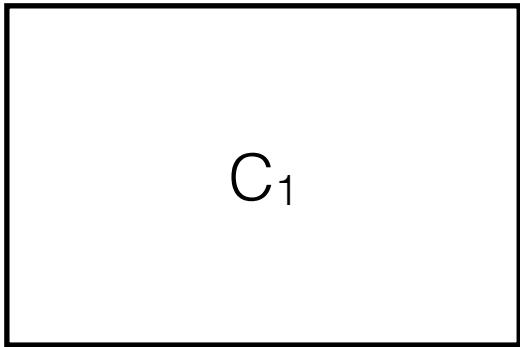


$\dots$

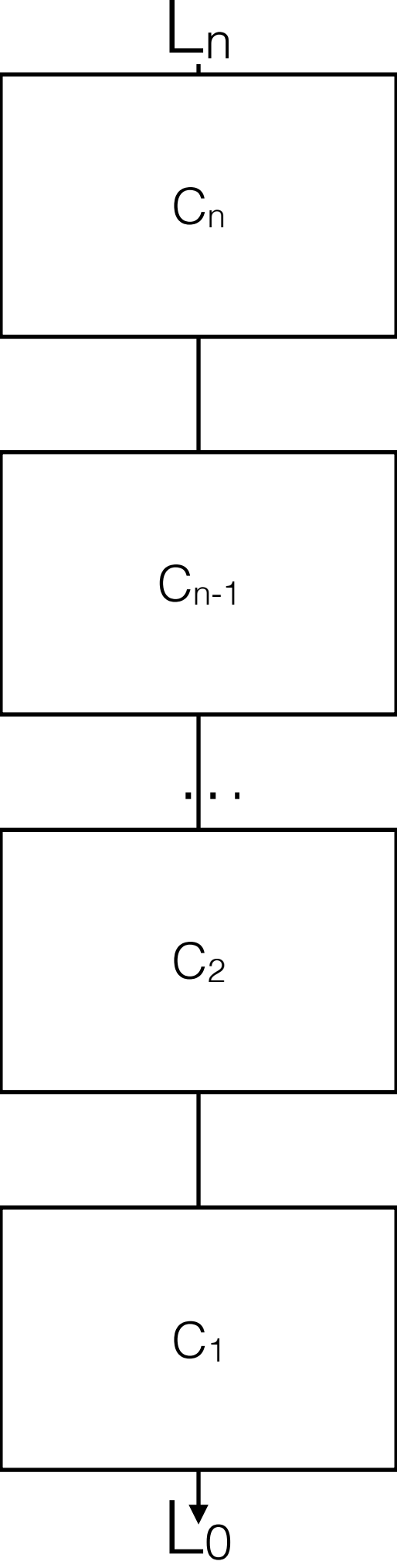
$C_2$

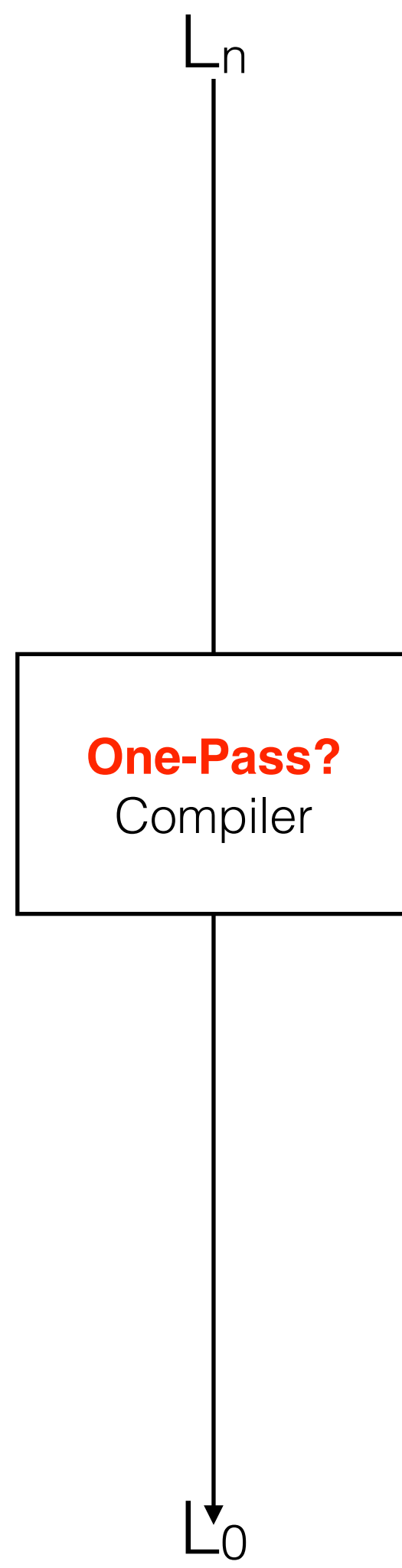
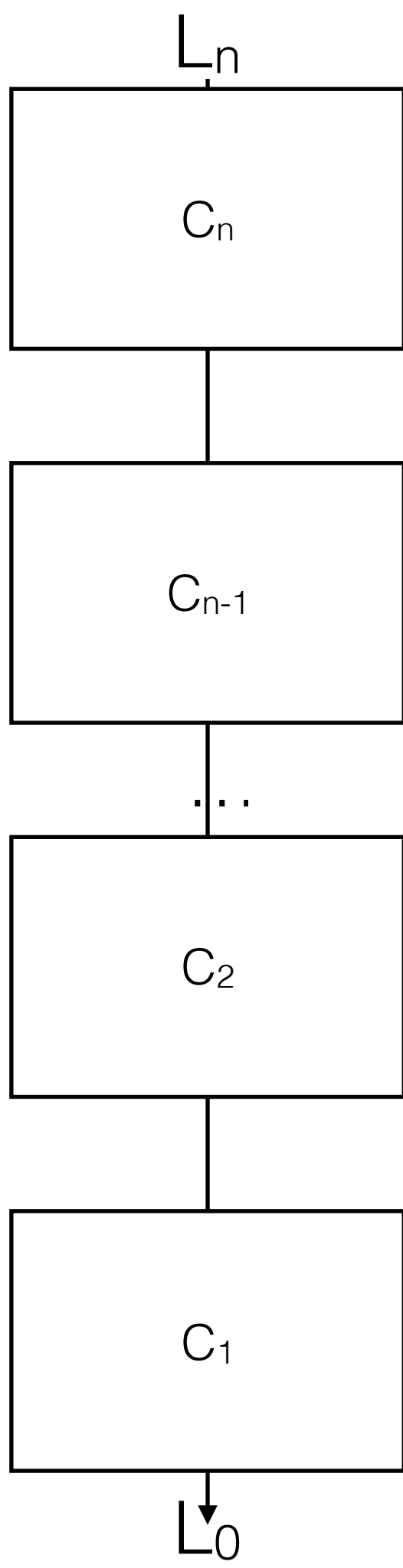


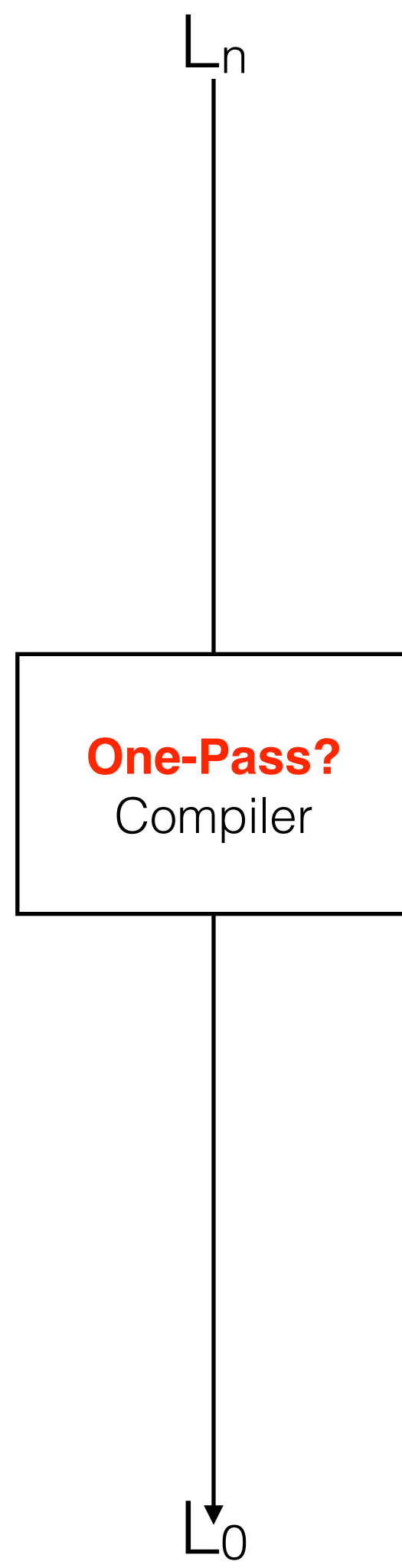
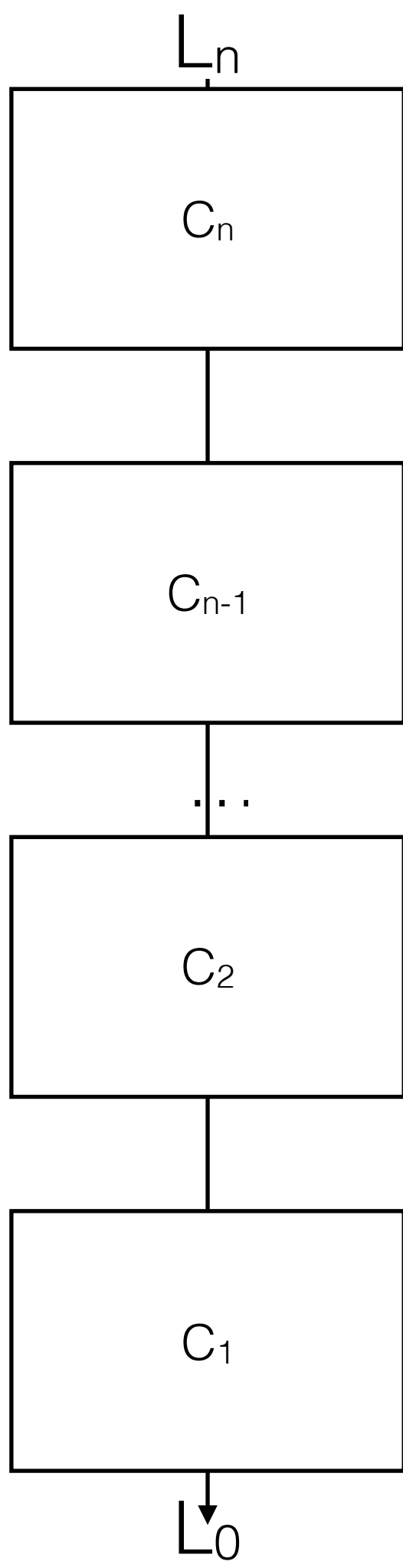
$C_1$



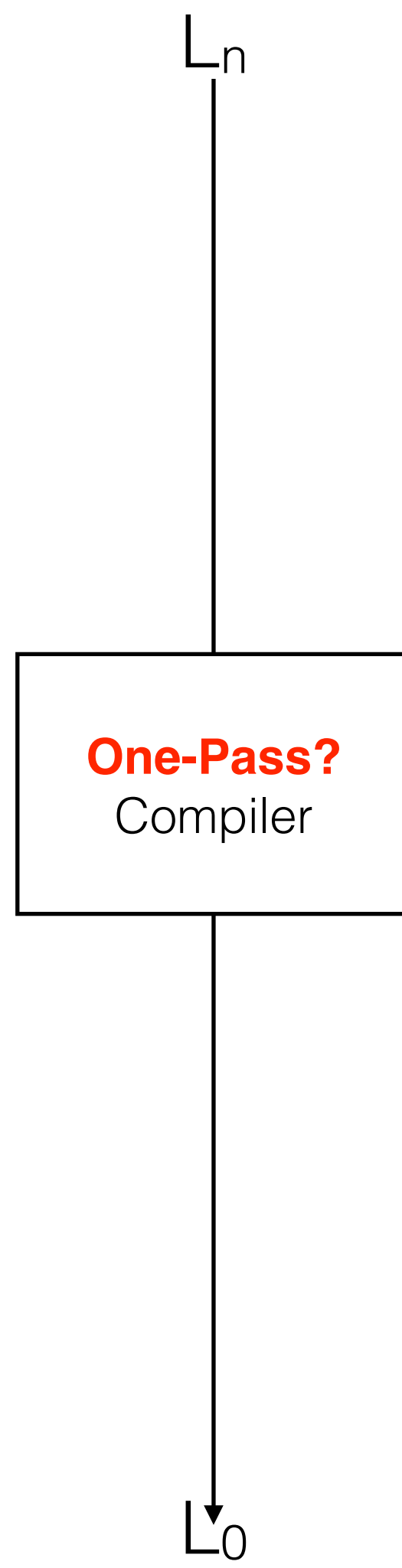
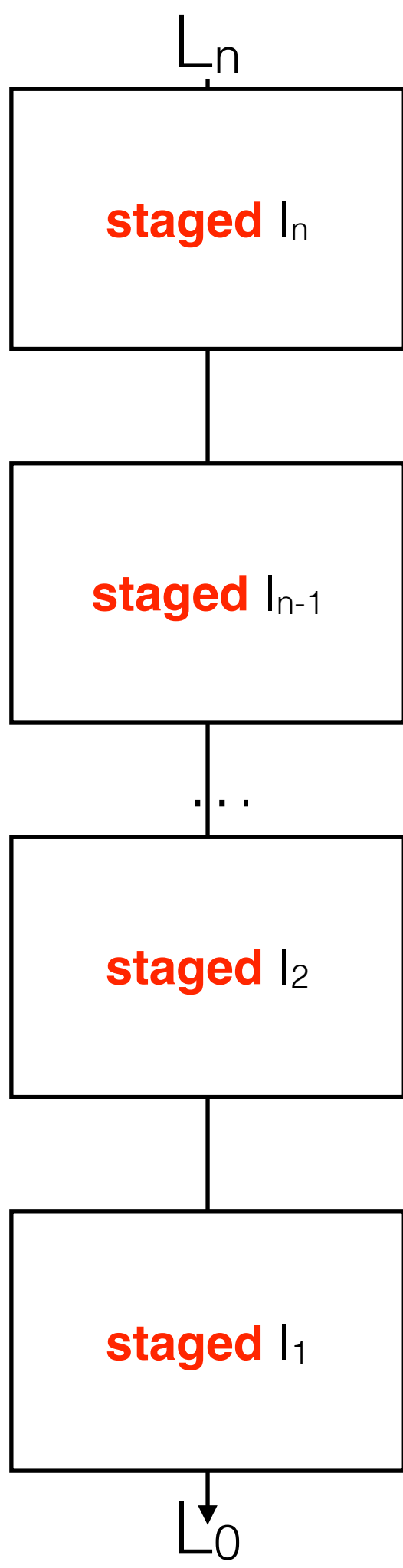
$L_0$







**reflection?**



**reflection?**

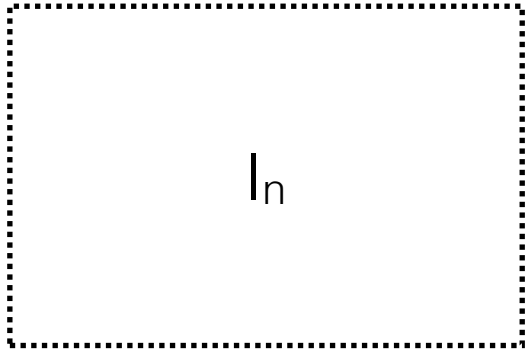


# Stage Polymorphism

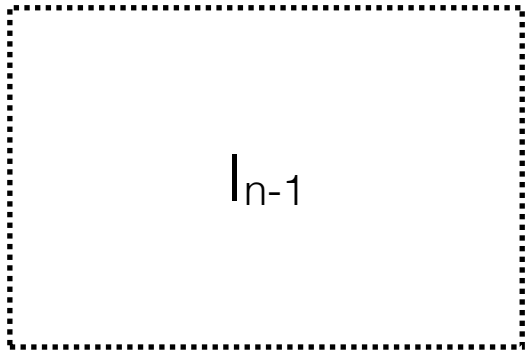




$L_n$

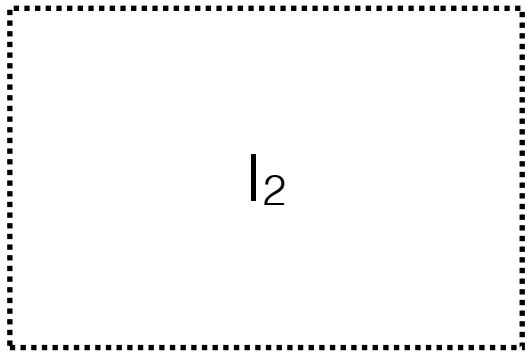


$I_n$

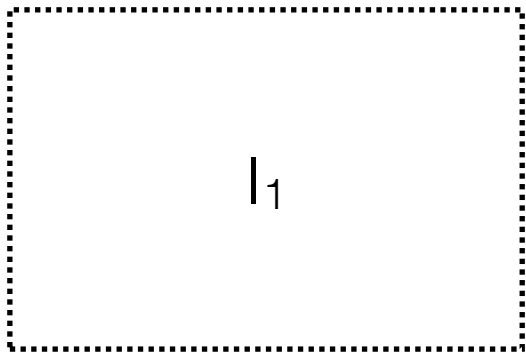


$I_{n-1}$

$\dots$

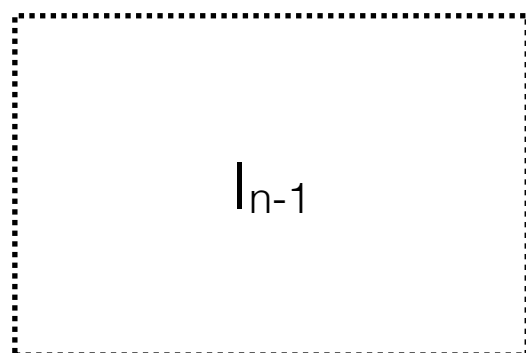
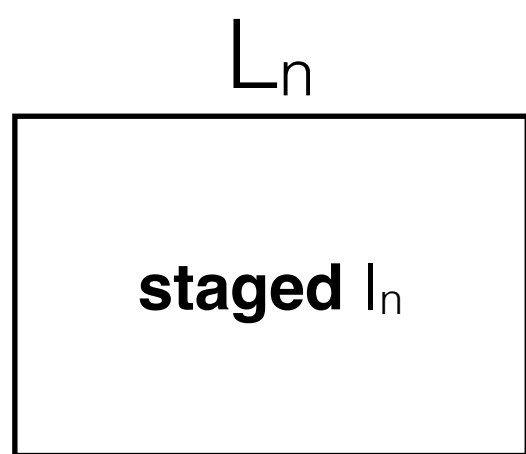


$I_2$

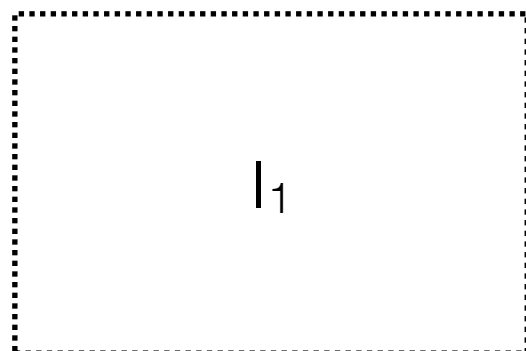
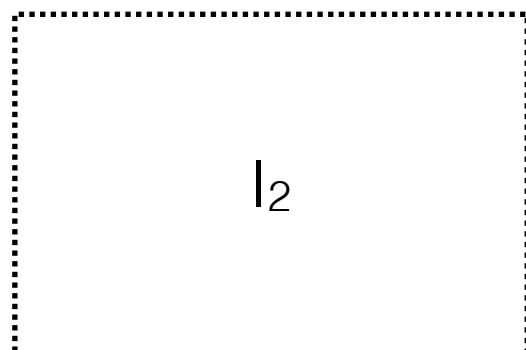


$I_1$

$L_0$

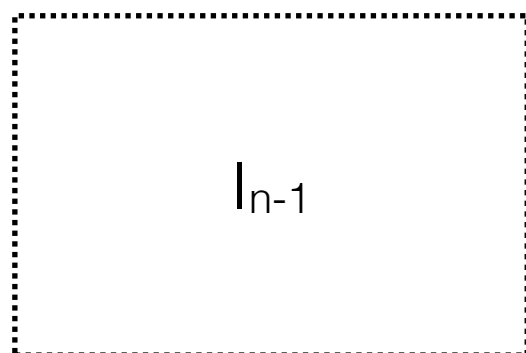
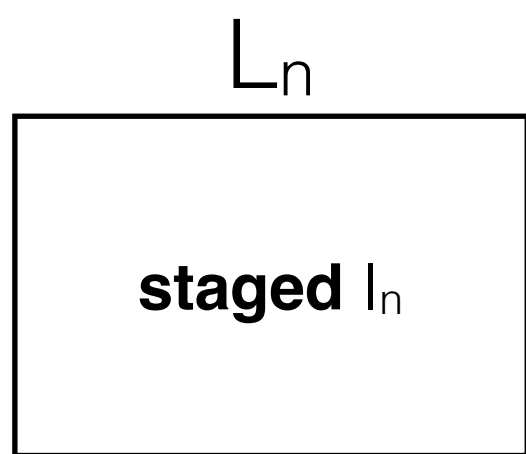


...

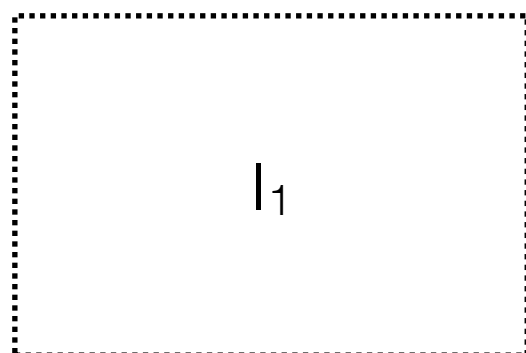
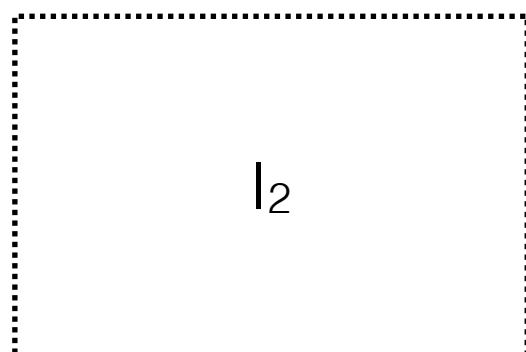


$L_0$

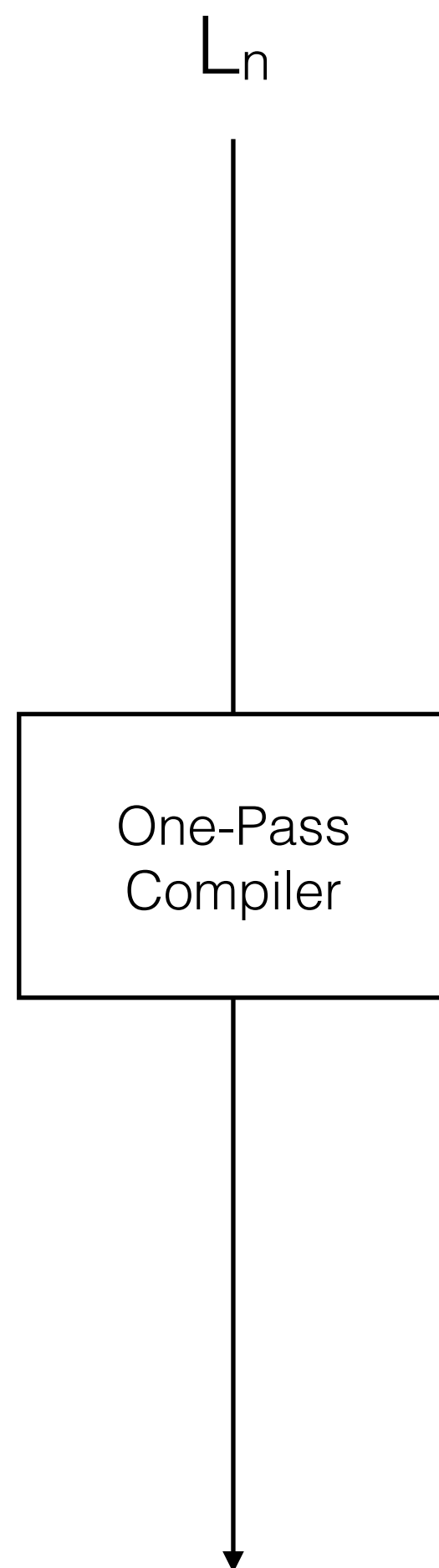
base  $L_0 = \lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow} = \mathbf{multi-level} \lambda\text{-calculus}$



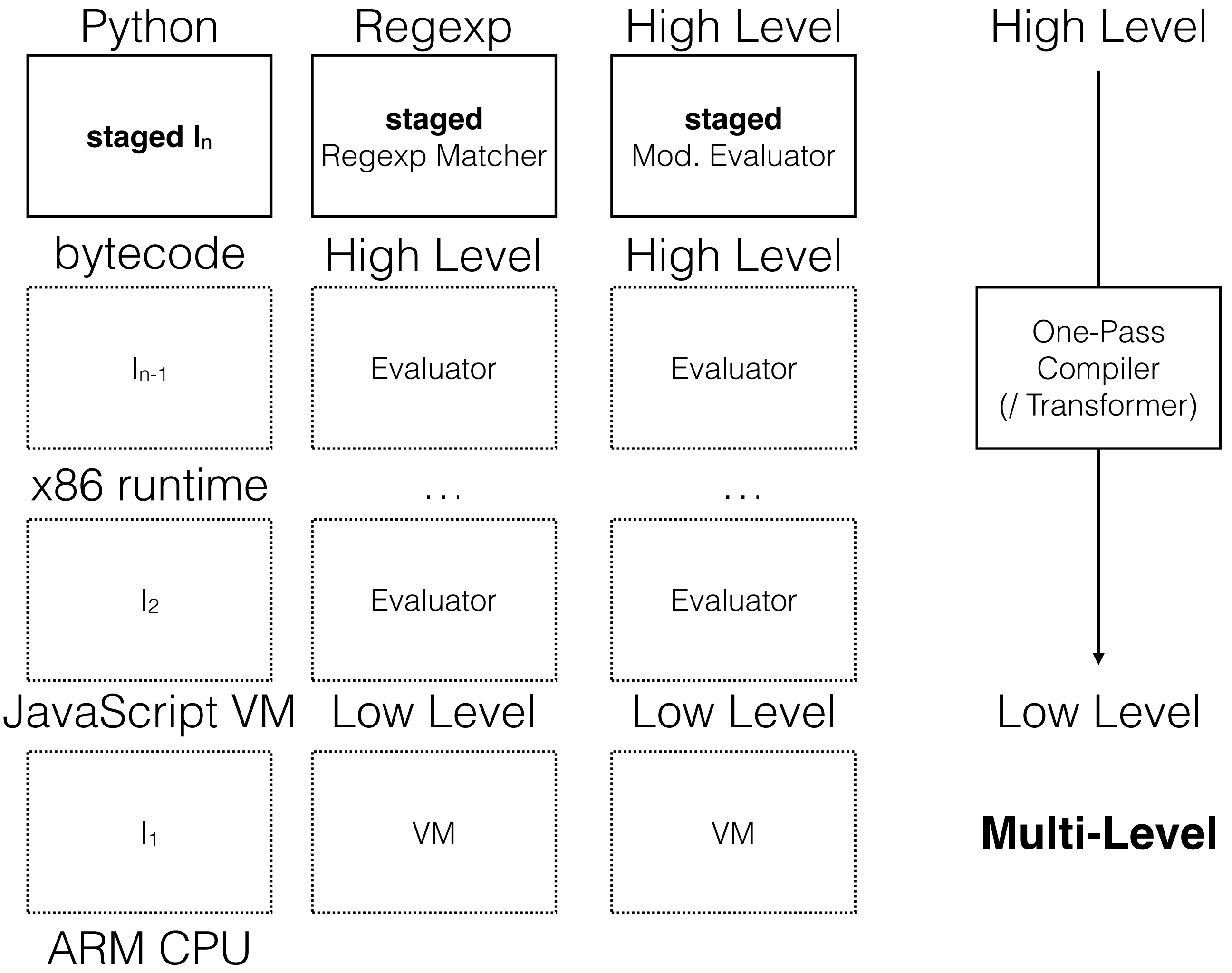
...

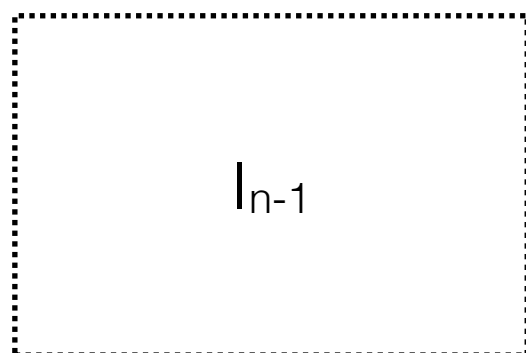
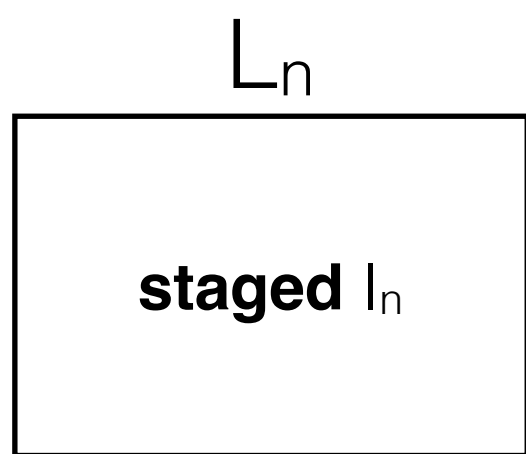


$L_0$

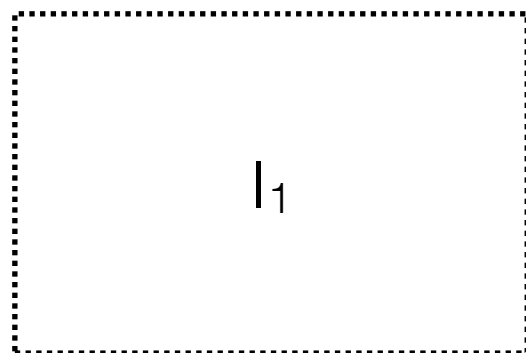
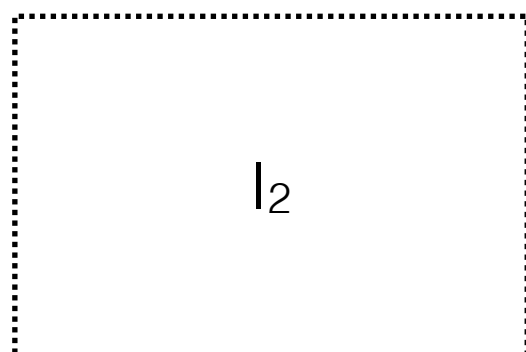


base  $L_0 = \lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow} = \mathbf{multi-level} \lambda\text{-calculus}$

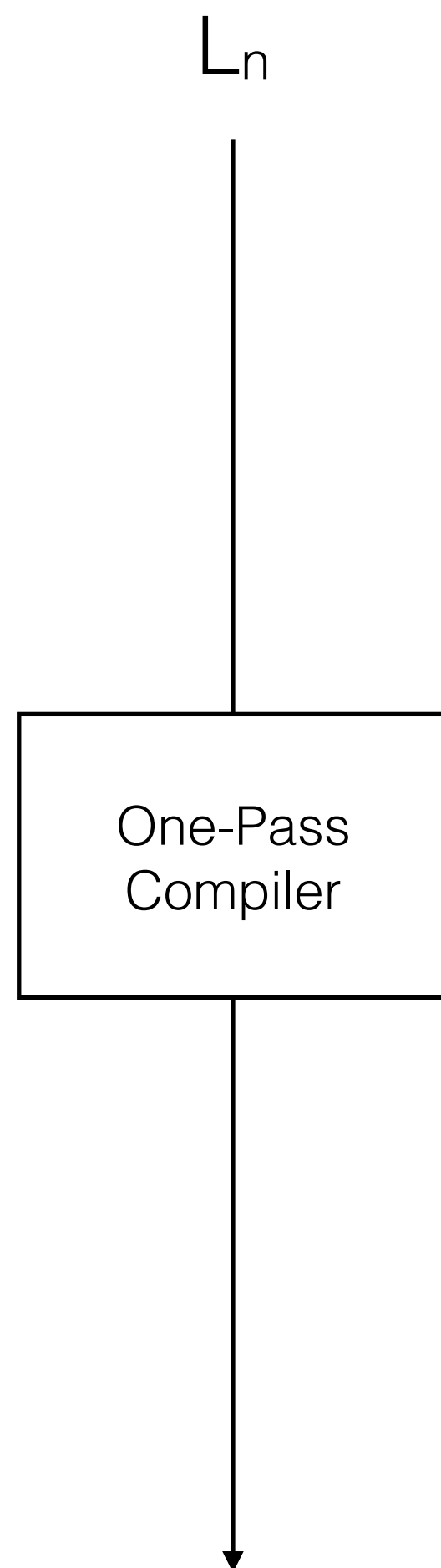




...



$L_0$



base  $L_0 = \lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow} = \mathbf{multi-level} \lambda\text{-calculus}$



# Pink & Purple



## Towers of Interpreters

- abstract over interpretation & compilation: stage-polymorphic multi-level lambda-calculus  $\lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow}$  or LMS & polytypic programming via type classes
- control collapse: explicit lifting or compilation unit
- tower size: finite or potentially infinite
- reflection, mutation, ...

$\lambda \uparrow \downarrow$



- Multi-level  $\lambda$ -calculus
- **Lift** operator
- **Let**-insertion
- Stage polymorphism
- Akin to manual *online* partial evaluation



# Definitional Interpreter in Scala (or Scheme)



# // Multi-stage evaluation

```
def evalms(env: Env, e: Exp): Val = e match {
  case Lit(n)          => Cst(n)
  case Var(n)          => env(n)
  case Cons(e1,e2)     => Tup(evalms(env,e1),evalms(env,e2))
  case Lam(e)          => Clo(env,e)
  case Let(e1,e2)      => val v1 = evalms(env,e1); evalms(env:+v1,e2)
  case App(e1,e2)      => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Clo(env3,e3), v2) => evalms(env3:+Clo(env3,e3):+v2,e3)
    case (Code(s1), Code(s2)) => reflectc(App(s1,s2)) }
  case If(c,a,b)       => evalms(env,c) match {
    case Cst(n)         => if (n != 0) evalms(env,a) else evalms(env,b)
    case Code(c1)       => reflectc(If(c1, reifyc(evalms(env,a)), reifyc(evalms(env,b)))) }
  case IsNum(e1)       => evalms(env,e1) match {
    case Code(s1)       => reflectc(IsNum(s1))
    case Cst(n)         => Cst(1)
    case v              => Cst(0) }
  case Plus(e1,e2)     => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Cst(n1), Cst(n2)) => Cst(n1+n2)
    case (Code(s1),Code(s2)) => reflectc(Plus(s1,s2)) }
  ...
  case Lift(e)         => liftc(evalms(env,e))
  case Run(b,e)        => evalms(env,b) match {
    case Code(b1)       => reflectc(Run(b1, reifyc(evalms(env,e))))
    case _              => evalmsg(env, reifyc({ stFresh = env.length; evalms(env, e) }))) }
```

# Stage Polymorphism

# // Multi-stage evaluation

```
def evalms(env: Env, e: Exp): Val = e match {
  case Lit(n)          => Cst(n)
  case Var(n)          => env(n)
  case Cons(e1,e2)     => Tup(evalms(env,e1),evalms(env,e2))
  case Lam(e)          => Clo(env,e)
  case Let(e1,e2)      => val v1 = evalms(env,e1); evalms(env:+v1,e2)
  case App(e1,e2)      => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Clo(env3,e3), v2) => evalms(env3:+Clo(env3,e3):+v2,e3)
    case (Code(s1), Code(s2)) => reflectc(App(s1,s2)) }
  case If(c,a,b)       => evalms(env,c) match {
    case Cst(n)         => if (n != 0) evalms(env,a) else evalms(env,b)
    case Code(c1)       => reflectc(If(c1, reifyc(evalms(env,a)), reifyc(evalms(env,b)))) }
  case IsNum(e1)       => evalms(env,e1) match {
    case Code(s1)       => reflectc(IsNum(s1))
    case Cst(n)         => Cst(1)
    case v              => Cst(0) }
  case Plus(e1,e2)     => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Cst(n1), Cst(n2)) => Cst(n1+n2)
    case (Code(s1),Code(s2)) => reflectc(Plus(s1,s2)) }
  ...
  case Lift(e)         => liftc(evalms(env,e))
  case Run(b,e)        => evalms(env,b) match {
    case Code(b1)       => reflectc(Run(b1, reifyc(evalms(env,e))))
    case _              => evalmsg(env, reifyc({ stFresh = env.length; evalms(env, e) }))) }
```

# // Multi-stage evaluation

```
def evalms(env: Env, e: Exp): Val = e match {
  case Lit(n)          => Cst(n)
  case Var(n)          => env(n)
  case Cons(e1,e2)     => Tup(evalms(env,e1),evalms(env,e2))
  case Lam(e)          => Clo(env,e)
  case Let(e1,e2)      => val v1 = evalms(env,e1); evalms(env:+v1,e2)
  case App(e1,e2)      => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Clo(env3,e3), v2) => evalms(env3:+Clo(env3,e3):+v2,e3)
    case (Code(s1), Code(s2)) => reflectc(App(s1,s2)) }
  case If(c,a,b)       => evalms(env,c) match {
    case Cst(n)          => if (n != 0) evalms(env,a) else evalms(env,b)
    case Code(c1)        => reflectc(If(c1, reifyc(evalms(env,a)), reifyc(evalms(env,b)))) }
  case IsNum(e1)       => evalms(env,e1) match {
    case Code(s1)        => reflectc(IsNum(s1))
    case Cst(n)          => Cst(1)
    case v               => Cst(0) }
  case Plus(e1,e2)     => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Cst(n1), Cst(n2)) => Cst(n1+n2)
    case (Code(s1),Code(s2)) => reflectc(Plus(s1,s2)) }
  ...
  case Lift(e)         => liftc(evalms(env,e))
  case Run(b,e)        => evalms(env,b) match {
    case Code(b1)        => reflectc(Run(b1, reifyc(evalms(env,e))))
    case _               => evalmsg(env, reifyc({ stFresh = env.length; evalms(env, e) }))) }
```

# // Multi-stage evaluation

```
def evalms(env: Env, e: Exp): Val = e match {
  case Lit(n)          => Cst(n)
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  case Cons(e1,e2)     => Tup(evalms(env,e1),evalms(env,e2))
  case Lam(e)          => Clo(env,e)
  case Let(e1,e2)      => val v1 = evalms(env,e1); evalms(env:+v1,e2)
  case App(e1,e2)      => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Clo(env3,e3), v2) => evalms(env3:+Clo(env3,e3):+v2,e3)
    case (Code(s1), Code(s2)) => reflectc(App(s1,s2)) }
  case If(c,a,b)       => evalms(env,c) match {
    case Cst(n)          => if (n != 0) evalms(env,a) else evalms(env,b)
    case Code(c1)        => reflectc(If(c1, reifyc(evalms(env,a)), reifyc(evalms(env,b)))) }
  case IsNum(e1)       => evalms(env,e1) match {
    case Code(s1)        => reflectc(IsNum(s1))
    case Cst(n)          => Cst(1)
    case v               => Cst(0) }
  case Plus(e1,e2)     => (evalms(env,e1), evalms(env,e2)) match {
    case (Cst(n1), Cst(n2)) => Cst(n1+n2)
    case (Code(s1),Code(s2)) => reflectc(Plus(s1,s2)) }
  ...
  case Lift(e)         => liftc(evalms(env,e))
  case Run(b,e)        => evalms(env,b) match {
    case Code(b1)        => reflectc(Run(b1, reifyc(evalms(env,e))))
    case _               => evalmsg(env, reifyc({ stFresh = env.length; evalms(env, e) }))) }
```

# Lift

```
def lift(v: Val): Exp = v match {  
  case Cst(n)          => Lit(n)  
  case Tup(a,b)        => val (Code(u),Code(v))=(a,b);  
    reflect(Cons(u,v))  
  case Clo(env2,e2) => reflect(Lam(reifyc(evalms(  
    env2:+Code(fresh()):+Code(fresh()),e2))))  
  case Code(e)         => reflect(Lift(e)) }  
  
def liftc(v: Val) = Code(lift(v))
```

# Lift

```
def lift(v: Val): Exp = v match {  
  case Cst(n)          => Lit(n)  
  case Tup(a,b)        => val (Code(u),Code(v))=(a,b);  
    reflect(Cons(u,v))  
  case Clo(env2,e2) => reflect(Lam(reifyc(evalms(  
    env2:+Code(fresh()):+Code(fresh()),e2))))  
  case Code(e)         => reflect(Lift(e)) }  
  
def liftc(v: Val) = Code(lift(v))
```



# Lift

```
def lift(v: Val): Exp = v match {  
  case Cst(n)          => Lit(n)  
  case Tup(a,b)        => val (Code(u), Code(v)) = (a,b);  
    reflect(Cons(u,v))  
  case Clo(env2,e2) => reflect(Lam(reifyc(evalms(  
    env2:+Code(fresh()):+Code(fresh()),e2))))  
  case Code(e)         => reflect(Lift(e)) }  
  
def liftc(v: Val) = Code(lift(v))
```



# Lift

```
def lift(v: Val): Exp = v match {  
  case Cst(n)          => Lit(n)  
  case Tup(a,b)         => val (Code(u),Code(v))=(a,b);  
    reflect(Cons(u,v))  
  case Clo(env2,e2) => reflect(Lam(reifyc(evalms(  
    env2:+Code(fresh()):+Code(fresh()),e2))))  
  case Code(e)         => reflect(Lift(e)) }  
  
def liftc(v: Val) = Code(lift(v))
```

# API for Let-Insertion

```
var stFresh: Int      = 0
var stBlock: List[Exp] = Nil
def fresh()           = {stFresh += 1; Var(stFresh-1)}
def run[A](f: => A): A = {val sF = stFresh; val sB = stBlock; try f finally {stFresh = sF; stBlock = sB}}

def reify(f: => Exp) = run{stBlock = Nil; val last = f;
  (stBlock foldRight last)(Let)}

def reflect(s: Exp)   = {stBlock :+= s; fresh()}

def reifyc(f: => Val)  = reify{val Code(e) = f; e}
def reflectc(s: Exp)  = Code(reflect(s))

def reifyv(f: => Val)  = run{stBlock = Nil; val res = f; if (stBlock == Nil) res else {
  val Code(last) = res; Code((stBlock foldRight last)(Let))}}
```

# API for Let-Insertion

```
var stFresh: Int      = 0
var stBlock: List[Exp] = Nil
def fresh()           = {stFresh += 1; Var(stFresh-1)}
def run[A](f: => A): A = {val sF = stFresh; val sB = stBlock; try f finally {stFresh = sF; stBlock = sB}}

def reify(f: => Exp) = run{stBlock = Nil; val last = f;
  (stBlock foldRight last)(Let)}

def reflect(s: Exp)    = {stBlock :+= s; fresh()}

def reifyc(f: => Val)  = reify{val Code(e) = f; e}
def reflectc(s: Exp)   = Code(reflect(s))
def reifyv(f: => Val)  = run{stBlock = Nil; val res = f; if (stBlock == Nil) res else {
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```

```
def reify(f: => Exp) = run{stBlock = Nil; val last = f;
  (stBlock foldRight last)(Let)}
```

```
def reflect(s: Exp) = {stBlock :+= s; fresh()}
```

```
def reifyc(f: => Val) = reify{val Code(e) = f; e}
def reflectc(s: Exp) = Code(reflect(s))
def reifyv(f: => Val) = run{stBlock = Nil; val res = f; if (stBlock == Nil) res else {
  val Code(last) = res; Code((stBlock foldRight last)(Let))}}
```

$\lambda \uparrow \downarrow$

- Multi-level  $\lambda$ -calculus
- **Lift** operator
- **Let**-insertion
- Stage polymorphism



Pink:

# Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator



# *;; Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator for Pink*

```
(lambda _ maybe-lift (lambda _ eval (lambda _ exp (lambda _ env
  (if (num?          exp) (maybe-lift exp)
  (if (sym?          exp) (env exp)
  (if (sym?          (car exp))
    (if (eq? '+'      (car exp)) (+ ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '-'      (car exp)) (- ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '*'      (car exp)) (* ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'eq?     (car exp)) (eq? ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'if      (car exp)) (if ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env)
                                     ((eval (cadddr exp)) env)))

  (if (eq? 'lambda (car exp)) (maybe-lift (lambda f x ((eval (cadddr exp))
    (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) f (if (eq? y (caddr exp)) x (env y)))))))
  (if (eq? 'let     (car exp)) (let x ((eval (caddr exp)) env) ((eval (cadddr exp))
    (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) x (env y)))))
  (if (eq? 'lift    (car exp)) (lift ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'run     (car exp)) (run ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'num?    (car exp)) (num? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'sym?    (car exp)) (sym? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'car     (car exp)) (car ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'cdr     (car exp)) (cdr ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'cons    (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cons ((eval (cadr exp)) env)
    ((eval (caddr exp)) env)))

  (if (eq? 'quote   (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cadr exp))
  ((env (car exp)) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))))))
(((eval (car exp)) env) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))
```



# *:: Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator for Pink*

```
(lambda _ maybe-lift (lambda _ eval (lambda _ exp (lambda _ env
  (if (num?      exp) (maybe-lift exp)
  (if (sym?      exp) (env exp)
  (if (sym?      (car exp))
    (if (eq? '+    (car exp)) (+ ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '-    (car exp)) (- ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '*    (car exp)) (* ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'eq?  (car exp)) (eq? ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'if   (car exp)) (if ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env)
                                  ((eval (caddrr exp)) env)))

  (if (eq? 'lambda (car exp)) (maybe-lift (lambda f x ((eval (caddrr exp))
    (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) f (if (eq? y (caddr exp)) x (env y)))))))
  (if (eq? 'let   (car exp)) (let x ((eval (caddr exp)) env) ((eval (caddrr exp))
    (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) x (env y)))))
  (if (eq? 'lift  (car exp)) (lift ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'run   (car exp)) (run ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'num?  (car exp)) (num? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'sym?  (car exp)) (sym? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'car   (car exp)) (car ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'cdr   (car exp)) (cdr ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
  (if (eq? 'cons  (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cons ((eval (cadr exp)) env)
    ((eval (caddr exp)) env)))

  (if (eq? 'quote (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cadr exp)
    ((env (car exp)) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))))))
(((eval (car exp)) env) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))
```



# *:: Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator for Pink*

```
(lambda _ maybe-lift (lambda _ eval (lambda _ exp (lambda _ env
  (if (num?      exp) (maybe-lift exp)
  (if (sym?      exp) (env exp)
  (if (sym?      (car exp))
    (if (eq? '+    (car exp)) (+ ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '-    (car exp)) (- ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '*    (car exp)) (* ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'eq?  (car exp)) (eq? ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'if   (car exp)) (if ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env)
                                  ((eval (caddrr exp)) env))

    (if (eq? 'lambda (car exp)) (maybe-lift (lambda f x ((eval (caddrr exp))
      (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) f (if (eq? y (caddr exp)) x (env y))))))
    (if (eq? 'let    (car exp)) (let x ((eval (caddr exp)) env) ((eval (caddrr exp))
      (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) x (env y))))
    (if (eq? 'lift   (car exp)) (lift ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'run    (car exp)) (run ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'num?   (car exp)) (num? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'sym?   (car exp)) (sym? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'car    (car exp)) (car ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'cdr    (car exp)) (cdr ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'cons   (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cons ((eval (cadr exp)) env)
      ((eval (caddr exp)) env)))

    (if (eq? 'quote  (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cadr exp))
      ((env (car exp)) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))))))
  (((eval (car exp)) env) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))
```

# *:: Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator for Pink*

```
(lambda _ maybe-lift (lambda _ eval (lambda _ exp (lambda _ env
  (if (num?          exp) (maybe-lift exp)
  (if (sym?          exp) (env exp)
  (if (sym?          (car exp))
    (if (eq? '+'      (car exp)) (+ ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '-'      (car exp)) (- ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? '*       (car exp)) (* ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'eq?     (car exp)) (eq? ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'if      (car exp)) (if ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env)
                                     ((eval (caddrr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'lambda (car exp)) (maybe-lift (lambda f x ((eval (caddrr exp))
      (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) f (if (eq? y (caddr exp)) x (env y))))))
    (if (eq? 'let     (car exp)) (let x ((eval (caddr exp)) env) ((eval (caddrr exp))
      (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) x (env y))))
    (if (eq? 'lift    (car exp)) (lift ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'run     (car exp)) (run ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'num?    (car exp)) (num? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'sym?    (car exp)) (sym? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'car     (car exp)) (car ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'cdr     (car exp)) (cdr ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
    (if (eq? 'cons    (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cons ((eval (cadr exp)) env)
      ((eval (caddr exp)) env)))
    (if (eq? 'quote   (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cadr exp)
      ((env (car exp)) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))))))
  (((eval (car exp)) env) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))
```

# *:: Stage-Polymorphic Meta-Circular Evaluator for Pink*

```
(lambda _ maybe-lift (lambda _ eval (lambda _ exp (lambda _ env
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    (if (sym?          exp) (env exp)
      (if (sym?      (car exp))
        (if (eq?    '+      (car exp)) (+      ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
          (if (eq?    '-      (car exp)) (-      ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
            (if (eq?    '*      (car exp)) (*      ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
              (if (eq?    'eq?      (car exp)) (eq? ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
                (if (eq?    'if      (car exp)) (if ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env)
                                                    ((eval (caddrdr exp)) env)))
              (if (eq?    'lambda (car exp)) (maybe-lift (lambda f x ((eval (caddrdr exp))
                (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) f (if (eq? y (caddr exp)) x (env y)))))))
                (if (eq?    'let      (car exp)) (let x ((eval (caddr exp)) env) ((eval (caddrdr exp))
                (lambda _ y (if (eq? y (cadr exp)) x (env y))))))
                (if (eq?    'lift     (car exp)) (lift ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
                  (if (eq?    'run     (car exp)) (run ((eval (cadr exp)) env) ((eval (caddr exp)) env))
                    (if (eq?    'num?   (car exp)) (num? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
                      (if (eq?    'sym?   (car exp)) (sym? ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
                        (if (eq?    'car   (car exp)) (car ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
                          (if (eq?    'cdr   (car exp)) (cdr ((eval (cadr exp)) env))
                            (if (eq?    'cons   (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cons ((eval (cadr exp)) env)
                            ((eval (caddr exp)) env)))
                              (if (eq?    'quote   (car exp)) (maybe-lift (cadr exp)
                                ((env (car exp)) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))))))))))
  (((eval (car exp)) env) ((eval (cadr exp)) env))))))
```

# Pink Interpretation

```
(define eval ((lambda ev e
  ((eval-poly (lambda _ e e) ev) e))
  #nil)))
```

```
(define fac-src (quote (lambda f n
  (if (eq? n 0) 1 (* n (f (- n 1)))))))
```

```
> ((eval fac-src) 4) ;=> 24
```



# Double & Triple Pink Interpretation

> ((eval fac-src) 4)

> (((eval eval-src) fac-src) 4)

> (((((eval eval-src) eval-src) fac-src) 4)

;=>24



# Pink Compilation

```
(define evalc ((lambda ev e  
  ((eval-poly (lambda _ e (lift e)))  
   ev) e)) #nil)))
```

```
(define fac-src (quote (lambda f n  
  (if (eq? n 0) 1 (* n (f (- n 1)))))))
```

> (evalc fac-src) *;> <code of fac>*



# Pink Collapsing

> (eval **c** fac-src)

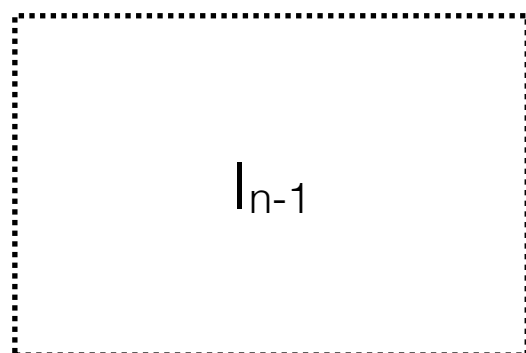
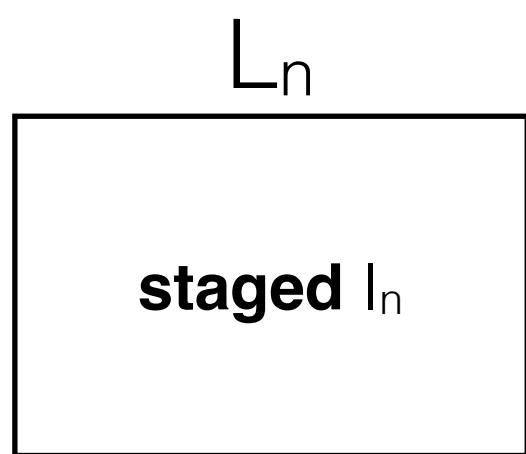
> ((eval eval **c**-src) fac-src)

> ((eval eval-src) eval **c**-src) fac-src)

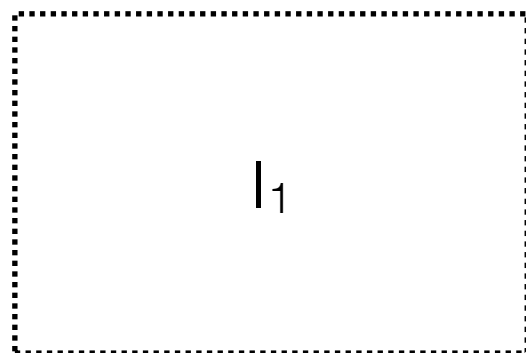
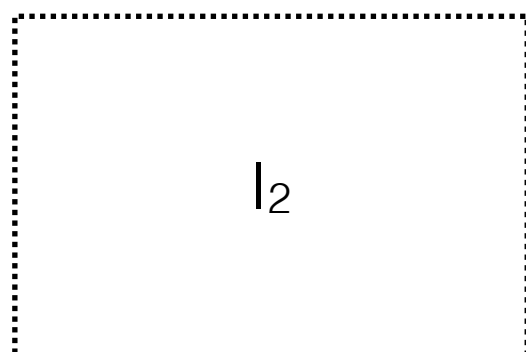
*;=> <code of fac>*



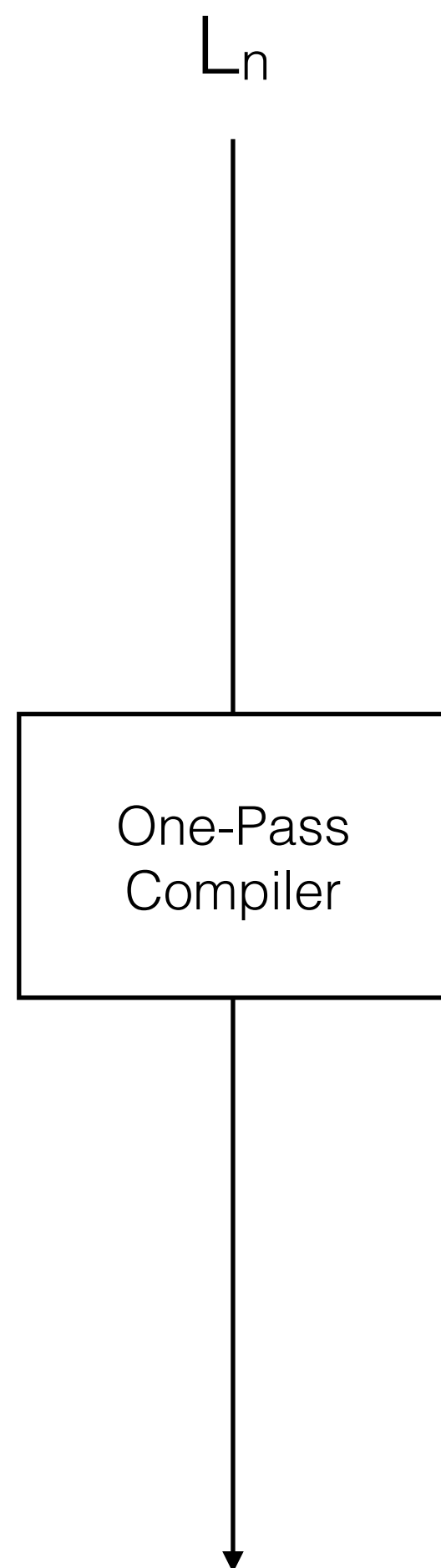




...

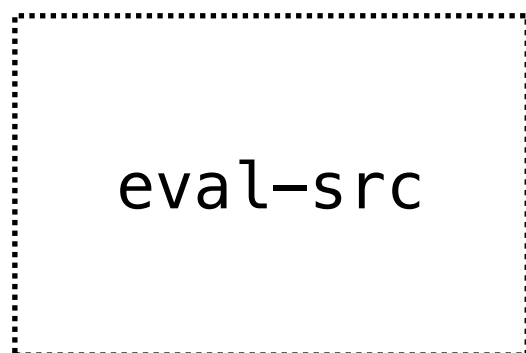
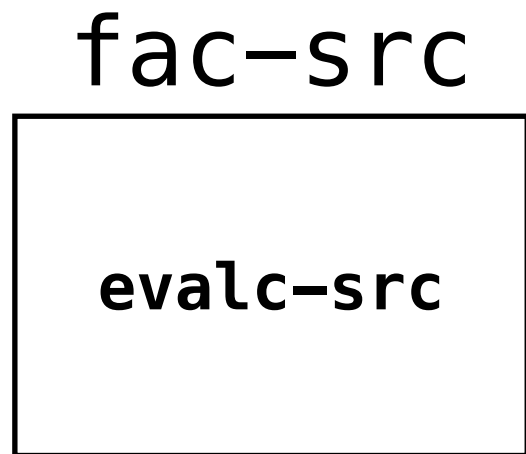


$L_0$

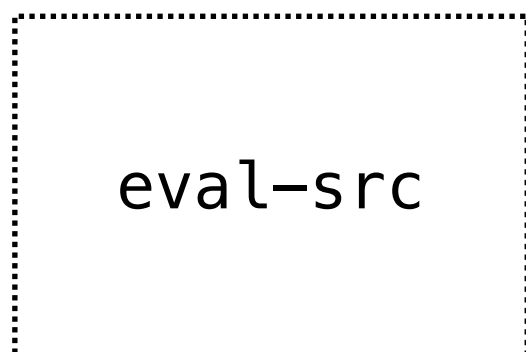


base  $L_0 = \lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow} = \mathbf{multi-level} \lambda\text{-calculus}$

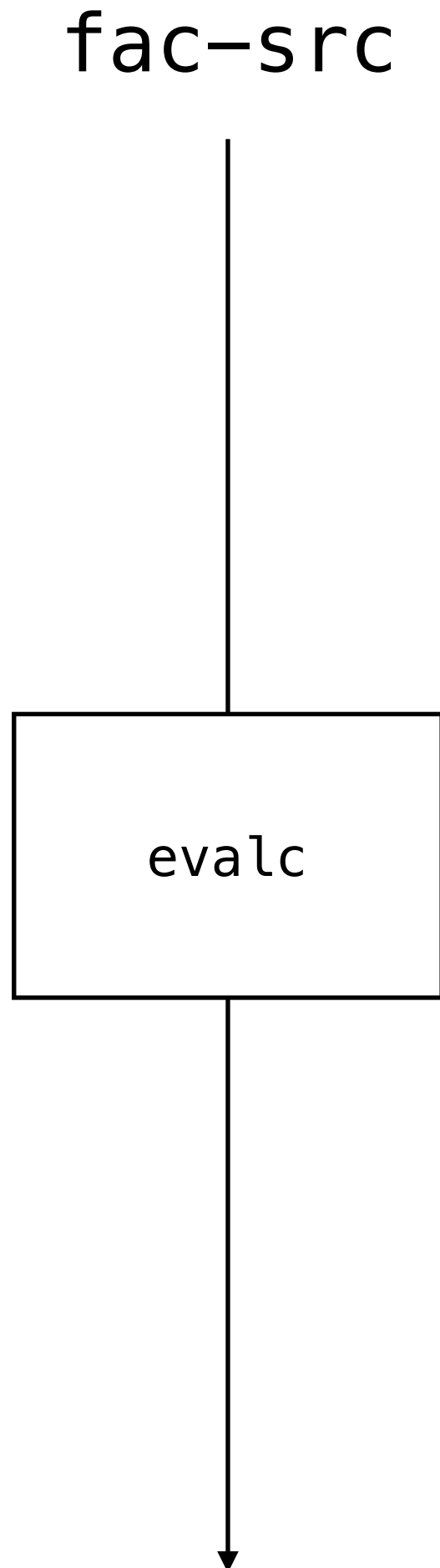




...



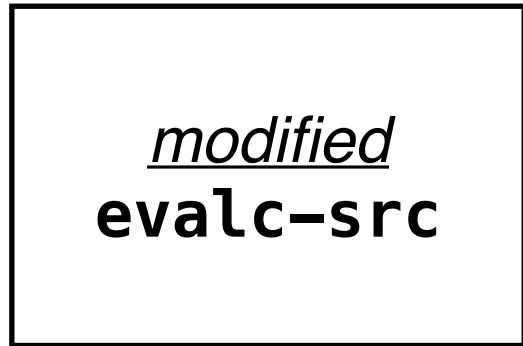
$\lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow}$



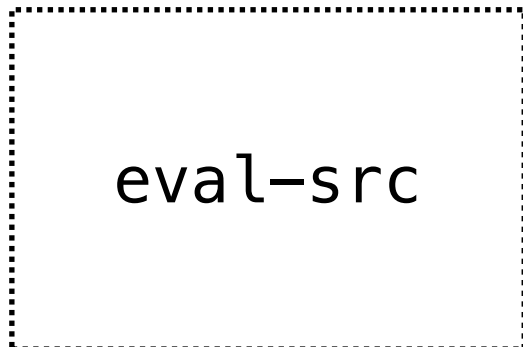
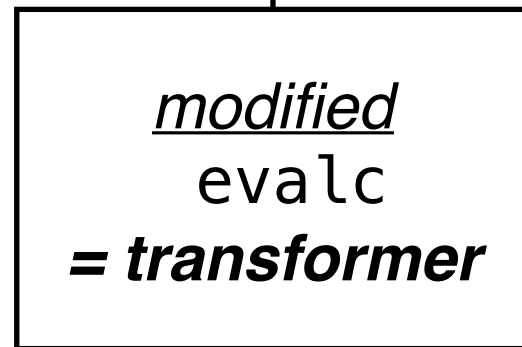
*<code of fac>*

> (((eval eval-src) ... eval-src)  
evalc-src) fac-src)  
*;<=> <code of fac>*

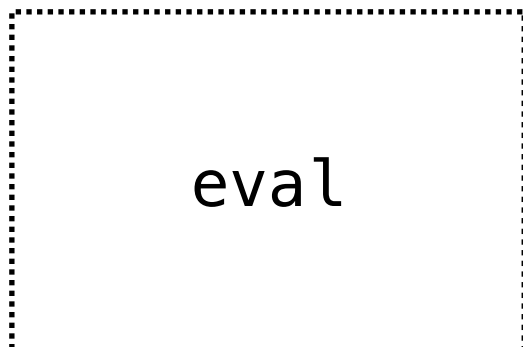
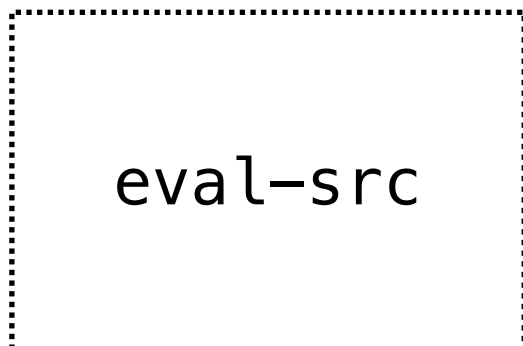
fac-src



fac-src



...



$\lambda_{\uparrow\downarrow}$

<*modified code of fac*>

> (((eval eval-src) ... eval-src)

*modified*-evalc-src) fac-src)

;=> <code of fac>

# Pink Transformers



```
> (evalc fac-src) ;; =>
(lambda f0 x1
  (let x2 (eq? x1 0)
    (if x2 1
      (let x3 (- x1 1)
        (let x4 (f0 x3)
          (* x1 x4)))))))
```

```
> (trace-n-evalc fac-src) ;; =>
(lambda f0 x1
  (let x2 (log 0 x1)
    (let x3 (eq? x2 0)
      (if x3 1
        (let x4 (log 0 x1)
          (let x5 (log 0 x1)
            (let x6 (- x5 1)
              (let x7 (f0 x6)
                (* x4 x7))))))))))
```

```
> (cps-evalc fac-src) ;; =>
(lambda f0 x1 (lambda f2 x3
  (let x4 (eq? x1 0)
    (if x4 (x3 1)
      (let x5 (- x1 1)
        (let x6 (f0 x5)
          (let x7 (lambda f7 x8
            (let x9 (* x1 x8) (x3 x9)))
            (x6 x7))))))))))
```

# Purple



- unit of compilation: **λambda** becomes **cλambda**
- conceptually infinite reflective tower based on Black
- Lightweight Modular Staging (LMS)
  - roughly akin to manual *offline* partial evaluation
  - staged polymorphism through type classes:  
**Rep [T]** vs **NoRep [T]** (= T) abstracted as **R [T]**

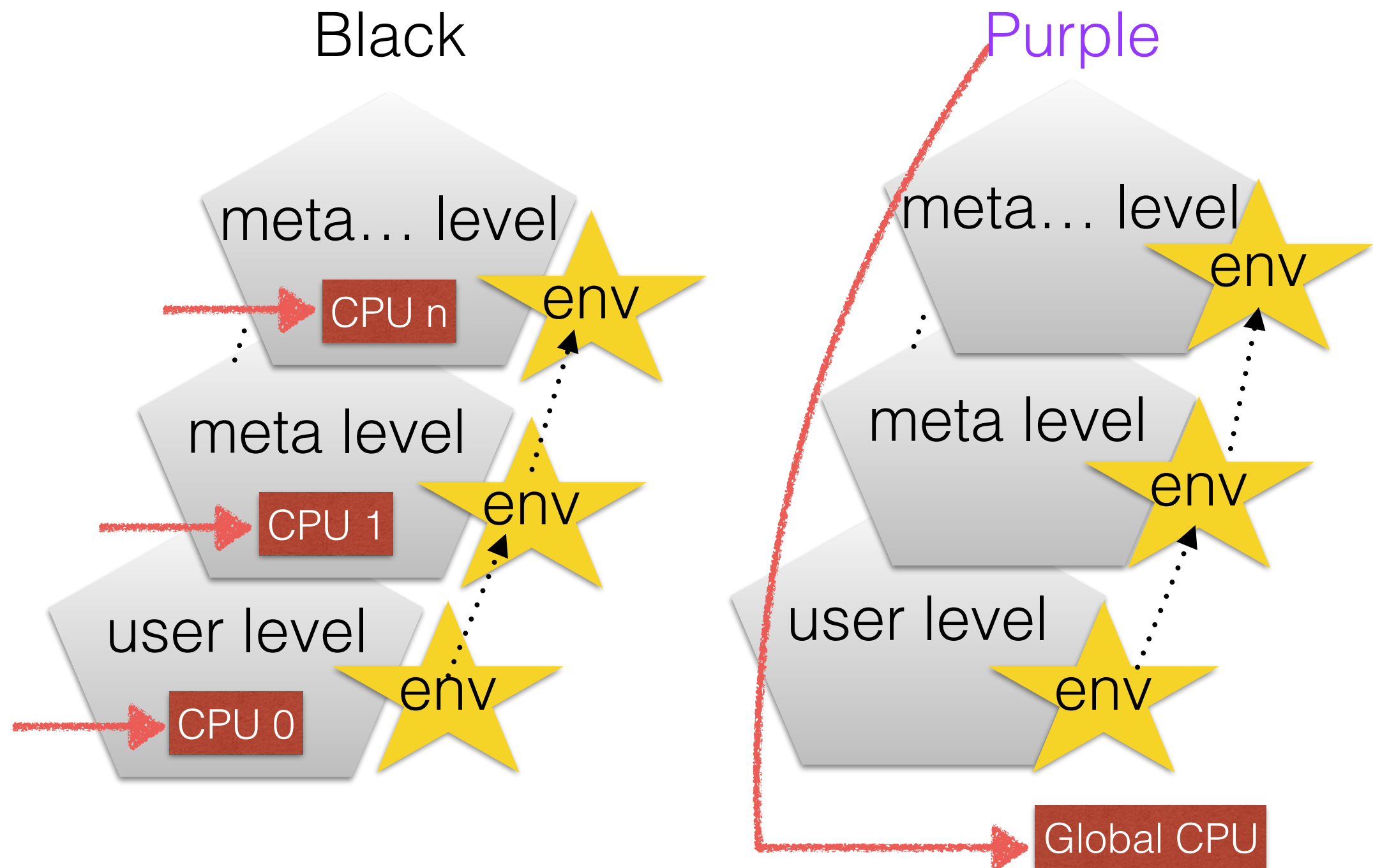
# Recall: Collapse in Purple

```
{(k, xs) => _app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)),  
_cont{c_1 => _cell_set(<cell counter>, c_1) _app('<', _cons(_car(xs),  
'(2)), _cont{v_1 => _if(_true(v_1),  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)), _cont{c_2 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_2)  
_app(k, _cons(_car(xs), '()), _cont{v_2 => v_2}})},  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)), _cont{c_3 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_3)  
_app('-', _cons(_car(xs), '(1)), _cont{v_3 => _app(_cell_read(<cell  
fib>), _cons(v_3, '()), _cont{v_4 =>  
_app('+', _cons(_cell_read(<cell counter>), '(1)), _cont{c_4 =>  
_cell_set(<cell counter>, c_4)  
_app('-', _cons(_car(xs), '(2)), _cont{v_5 => _app(_cell_read(<cell  
fib>), _cons(v_5, '()), _cont{v_6 =>  
_app('+', _cons(v_4, _cons(v_6, '()))}, _cont{v_7 => _app(k,  
_cons(v_7, '()), _cont{v_8 => v_8}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}}
```



```
trait Ops[R[_]] {  
  implicit def _lift(v: Value): R[Value]  
  def _liftb(b: Boolean): R[Boolean]  
  
  def _app(fun: R[Value], args: R[Value], cont: Value): R[Value]  
  def _fun(f: Fun[R]): R[Value]  
  def _cont(f: FunC[R]): Value  
  
  def _true(v: R[Value]): R[Boolean]  
  def _if(c: R[Boolean], a: =>R[Value], b: =>R[Value]): R[Value]  
  
  def _cons(car:R[Value],cdr:R[Value]): R[Value]  
  def _car(p: R[Value]): R[Value]  
  def _cdr(p: R[Value]): R[Value]  
  
  def _cell_new(v: R[Value], memo: String): R[Value]  
  def _cell_set(c: R[Value], v: R[Value]): R[Value]  
  def _cell_read(c: R[Value]): R[Value]  
  
  def inRep: Boolean  
}
```

# “Classic” vs Rigid Structures for Reflective Towers





# Purple: Modified Semantics

- (**EM** (**begin** (**define** counter 0)  
  (**define** old-eval-var eval-var)  
  (**set!** eval-var (**clambda** (e r k)  
    (**if** (eq? e 'n)  
      (**set!** counter (+ counter 1)))  
    (old-eval-var e r k)))))
- > (fib 7)                ; $\Rightarrow$  13  
  > (**EM** counter)       ; $\Rightarrow$  102
- (**set!** fib (**clambda** (n) ...))  
  (**EM** (**set!** counter 0))  
  > (fib 7)                ; $\Rightarrow$  13  
  > (**EM** counter)       ; $\Rightarrow$  102





# Purple: User-Level “Interpreter”



- (**define** matches  
  (**lambda** (r) (**lambda** (s)  
    (**if** (null? r) #t (**if** (null? s) #f  
      (**if** (eq? (car r) (car s))  
        (matches (cdr r) (cdr s)) #f))))))
- > (matches '(a b)) '(a c)) *;> #f*
- > (matches '(a b)) '(a b)) *;> #t*
- > (matches '(a b)) '(a b c)) *;> #t*

# Purple: User-Level Collapse

- (**define** start\_ab  
 ((**lambda** ()) (matches '(a b))))
- (**define** start\_ab (**lambda** (s)  
 (**if** (null? s) #f  
 (**if** (eq? 'a (car s)) ((**lambda** (s)  
 (**if** (null? s) #f  
 (**if** (eq? 'b (car s)) ((**lambda** (s)  
 #t) (cdr s)) #f))) (cdr s))))))





# Summary



- collapse towers of interpreters
  - using a stage-polymorphic multi-level lambda-calculus
  - using LMS and polytypic programming via type classes
- design: how to expose compilation/collapse?
  - explicit stage lifting
  - **clambda**
  - JIT? ...

# Potential Applications

- *Towers in the Wild*: e.g. Python on top of x86 runtime on top of JavaScript VM
- *Modified semantics*: e.g. instrumentation/tracing for debugging, sandboxing for security, virtualization, transactions
- *Non-standard interpretations*: program analysis, verification, synthesis, e.g. Racket interpreter on top of miniKanren, Abstracting abstract machines

# Thank you!



Code for **Pink** & **Purple**: [popl18.namin.net](http://popl18.namin.net)

Reflective towers: ... **Brown**, **Blond**, **Black**, ...

Staging & LMS: [scala-lms.github.io](http://scala-lms.github.io)

Stage polymorphism: [github.com/GeorgOfenbeck/SpaceTime](https://github.com/GeorgOfenbeck/SpaceTime)